

A Comparison of Autogenous Modernity in Donghak and Daesoon Thought

Comparison of Autogenous Modernity in Views of Heaven

The Three Powers (Samjae 三才) and the Three Realms (Samgye 三界)

According to the principle of liminality, where ontogeny recapitulates phylogeny, Daesoon Thought adds new characteristics to the characteristics of Donghak Thought. Therefore, a comparison of the two thoughts can be made through these newly emerging characteristics. Terms that uniquely appear in the Daesoon Thought's view of Heaven include Samgye (Three Realms) and Hucheon (Later World), which contrast with Donghak Thought's Samjae (Three Powers) and Seoncheon (Former World), respectively.

First, in Daesoon Thought, Samgye (Three Realms) refers to the Cheongye (Heavenly Realm), Jigye (Earthly Realm), and Ingye (Human Realm). Although Daoist thought individually mentions the Heavenly Realm, Subterranean Realm, etc., instances of using the expression Samgye (Three Realms) to collectively refer to them are rare. On the other hand, Daesoon Thought presupposes the "Three Realms" starting from the term Daesoon (Great Circuit), and the Cheonji Gongsang (Heavenly and Earthly Works), which is central to Daesoon Thought, is also expressed as a series of Samgye Gongsang (Works of the Three Realms).

That Samgye-gongsang is precisely the Gaebyeok (Great Opening) of the Three Realms of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity; and this Gaebyeok is not a matter of following what others have made, but is newly made, so it did not exist in the past, nor does it exist now; it is not inherited from others, nor is it a matter of Unsu (fortune/destiny), but is solely a matter that must be brought into being by Sangje.⁷⁶⁵

In the excerpt above, Samgye (Three Realms) is defined as collectively referring to the Heavenly Realm, Earthly Realm, and Human Realm. Samgye (Three Realms) appears as a core term of the doctrine that reveals the characteristics of Daesoon Thought. Samgye (三界, Three Realms) contrasts with Samjae (三才, Three Powers), but it first appears in Daesoon Thought and is used repeatedly. For example, in Daesoon Thought, Gucheon Daewon Jowajusin (九天大元造化主神) is the Samgye Jijon (三界至尊, Supreme Ruler of the Three Realms) who oversees (統察) the Three Realms and, while conducting the history of the Three Realms (三界役使), diagnoses the progression of the confusion of the Three Realms (三界混亂) into the disorder of the Three Realms (三界錯亂)—caused by the appeals of Shinseong (神聖, divine saints), Bul (佛, Buddhas), and Bosal (菩薩, Bodhisattvas)—through the Samgye Daesoon (三界大巡, Great Circuit of the Three Realms), and with the Samgye Daegweon (三界大權, Great Authority of the Three Realms), He performs the Samgye Gongsang (三界公事, Works of the Three Realms) which subdues the demons of the Three Realms (三界伏魔) and reconstructs (三界改造) the Three Realms, thereby

⁷⁶⁵ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Yeosi" (Prophetic Elucidations) 5.

exorcising the demons of the Three Realms (三界解魔), making the Three Realms transparent (透明), and achieving the Gaebyeok (開闢, Creation-Opening) of the Three Realms.⁷⁶⁶⁷⁶⁷⁷⁶⁸⁷⁶⁹⁷⁷⁰⁷⁷¹⁷⁷²⁷⁷³⁷⁷⁴⁷⁷⁵⁷⁷⁶⁷⁷⁷

These Three Realms (三界), when compared to the Three Powers (三才), reveal three characteristics. First, characteristics of the views of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity as seen from the perspective of Gucheon (the Ninth Heaven), such as Samgye Jijon (Supreme Ruler of the Three Realms) and Samgye Daesoon (Great Circuit of the Three Realms), are revealed. Second, because the "Gye (界)" in Samgye (三界, Three Realms) carries the meaning of a "system," it emphasizes the Sinmyeong-gye (Realm of Divine Beings) compared to Samjae (三才, Three Powers). Third, Samgye (三界, Three Realms), as indicated by the term "Gye (界)," simultaneously emphasizes Western substantiality in comparison to the Eastern Samjae (三才, Three Powers), which emphasizes attributes. Examining each characteristic in light of the usage examples of Samgye (Three Realms), they are as follows.

First, characteristics of the views of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity as seen from the perspective of Gucheon (the Ninth Heaven), such as Samgye Jijon (Supreme Ruler of the Three Realms) and Samgye Daesoon (Great Circuit of the Three Realms), are revealed in the Three Realms. Cheonju (Celestial Lord), that is, Gucheon Daewon Jowajusin (九天大元造化主神), as the Samgye Jijon (Supreme Ruler of the Three Realms), oversees (統察) the Three Realms and works within the Three Realms.

Cheonjon (天尊, Celestial Worthy) indicates that Sangje is the holiest and greatest deity throughout the Three Realms, who universally creates every being through His thunderbolt throughout all directions in space and time.⁷⁷⁸

⁷⁶⁶ Daesoon Jinrihoe Yeolam (Daesoon Jinrihoe Overview), p.7.

⁷⁶⁷ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gyoun" (Progress of the Order) 1-17.

⁷⁶⁸ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gyoun" (Progress of the Order) 1-9.

⁷⁶⁹ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Yeosi" (Prophetic Elucidations) 10.

⁷⁷⁰ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gyoun" (Progress of the Order) 1-9; Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gyoun" (Progress of the Order) 2-6.

⁷⁷¹ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Yeosi" (Prophetic Elucidations) 17; Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gwonji" (Authority and Foreknowledge) 1-21.

⁷⁷² Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Haengrok" (Acts) 5-38.

⁷⁷³ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Yeosi" (Prophetic Elucidations) 7.

⁷⁷⁴ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gongsa" (Reordering Works) 3.

⁷⁷⁵ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gyoun" (Progress of the Order) 1-30.

⁷⁷⁶ Daesoon Jinrihoe Yeolam (Daesoon Jinrihoe Overview), p.9

⁷⁷⁷ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gongsa" (Reordering Works) 1-2

⁷⁷⁸ Daesoon Jinrihoe Yeolam (Daesoon Jinrihoe Overview), "Sinang-ui Daesang" (Object of Faith).

Gucheon (九天, Heaven) is a name derived from the following scriptural passage: "...all the divine sages, buddhas, and bodhisattvas, who had existed since the dawn of time, gathered and petitioned Me in the Ninth Heaven..." This means that they appealed to the highest Celestial Worthy, the one who presides with supreme authority over the cosmos. The Ninth Heaven is the highest location of all, a post from which Sangje supervises the Three Realms, coordinates Heaven and Earth, and directs the process of their unfolding.⁷⁷⁹

The word Tongchal (統察, overseeing governance) is also, like Samgye (Three Realms), a term unique to Daesoon Thought, not found in standard Korean dictionaries. Standard Korean dictionaries only list Tongchal (洞察, insight) and Tongchal (通察, thorough investigation); the "Tong (統)" in Tongchal (統察) means "to lead" or "to command" (거느릴 통). Tongchal (統察, overseeing governance) is also distinguished from Tongje (統制, control); Tongje means to command and regulate, while Tongchal means to command and observe the great universe. Samgye Tongchal (overseeing governance of the Three Realms) means residing as the Samgye Jijon (Supreme Ruler of the Three Realms) and exercising the Samgye Daegweon (Great Authority of the Three Realms). Gucheon resides as the Samgye Jijon (Supreme Ruler of the Three Realms) and, in the Ninth Heaven, listens to the appeals of Shinseong (divine saints), Bul (Buddhas), and Bosal (Bodhisattvas).

"Establishing schools widely in this world to teach people is intended to greatly civilize the world, attach it to the history of the Three Realms, and resolve the grievances of divine beings and humans; however, the current school education causes learners to fall only into base utilitarianism, such as seeking government positions and salaries, and therefore, I have decided to allow the attainment of the Dao outside the established framework," He concluded His words.⁷⁸⁰

In the Seoncheon (Former World), the only way for divine beings to resolve their grievances was to respond to humans or be reborn as humans and achieve accomplishments of a higher level, and that was only possible through schools. Samgye Yeoksa (History of the Three Realms) is mentioned only once in the Jeon-gyeong. From the history of the Three Realms, it can be seen that the problems of the Three Realms are presented with humans as the answer to the problems.

Second, because the "Gye (界)" in Samgye (三界, Three Realms) carries the meaning of a "system," it emphasizes the Sinmyeong-gye (Realm of Divine Beings) compared to Samjae (三才, Three Powers). The indigenous modernity of Donghak Thought and Daesoon Thought is set against the backdrop of the conflict between the modernity of the Western views of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity, which emphasizes substance, and the traditional Eastern Samjae (Three Powers) thought, which emphasizes attributes. The Western substantial views of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity, centered on growth, had power but lacked stability; the

⁷⁷⁹ Daesoon Jinrihoe Yeolam (Daesoon Jinrihoe Overview), "Sinang-ui Daesang" (Object of Faith).

⁷⁸⁰ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gyoun" (Progress of the Order) 1-17.

Eastern Samjae-gwan (View of the Three Powers), centered on stability, presented integrative stability but lacked the power to respond to reality. Donghak Thought attempted to compensate for the power lacking in the Eastern Samjae-gwan by revealing the Cheonoecheon (Heaven beyond the Heavens) hidden in Eastern thought, but it could not be a sufficient method. In response, Daesoon Thought introduced the concept of Sinmyeong (divine beings) through the concept of Samgye (Three Realms), thereby presenting a method to integrate the Eastern and Western views of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity.

In Daesoon Thought, Gucheon (the Ninth Heaven Sangje) diagnoses, through the Samgye Daesoon (Great Circuit of the Three Realms), the progression of the confusion of the Three Realms (三界混亂) into the disorder of the Three Realms (三界錯亂), caused by the appeals of the Cheonji Sinmyeong (Heavenly and Earthly Divine Beings)—the Shinseong (divine saints), Bul (Buddhas), and Bosal (Bodhisattvas).⁷⁸¹⁷⁸²⁷⁸³

Daesoon Jinrihoe is based on the appeal of the Cheonji Sinmyeong (Heavenly and Earthly Divine Beings) to correct the Three Realms (三界) that had lost their proper course (常道), whereupon Gucheon Sangje (九天上帝, Sangje of the Ninth Heaven) descended to the human world (人世), rectified the Cheonji Dosu (Heavenly and Earthly Degrees) that had lost their proper course, in order to save the world (匡救天下), proclaimed the principles (道理) of Haewon Sangsaeng (Resolution of Grievances for Mutual Beneficence) to the Human Realm (人界), and after completing the accompanying Great Work (大公事) over forty years, He ascended (化天).⁷⁸⁴

The "appeal of the Cheonji Sinmyeong" refers to the "appeal made to the Gucheon (Ninth Heaven) by all the Shinseong (神聖, divine saints), Bul (佛, Buddhas), and Bosal (菩薩, Bodhisattvas) who had gathered." Accordingly, all Shinseong (divine saints), Bul (Buddhas), and Bosal (Bodhisattvas) are expressed as Cheonji Sinmyeong (Heavenly and Earthly Divine Beings). Divine beings connect attributes and substance, causing substance to move according to attributes and attributes to be revealed as substance. Depending on the role of the divine beings, the Three Realms fall into confusion or escape from confusion.

...(Omitted)... That civilization, being biased toward materialism, instead fostered human arrogance, and eventually, by attempting to shake the heavenly principles and conquer nature, it endlessly committed all sorts of sins, undermining the authority of the divine way (Shindo), thus the proper courses of the Heavenly Dao and human affairs were violated, the Three Realms fell into confusion, and the source of the Dao was severed; therefore, all the primeval Shinseong (divine saints), Bul (Buddhas), and Bosal

⁷⁸¹ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gyoun" (Progress of the Order) 1-9.

⁷⁸² Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Yeosi" (Prophetic Elucidations) 10.

⁷⁸³ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gyoun" (Progress of the Order) 1-9; Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gyoun" (Progress of the Order) 2-6.

⁷⁸⁴ Podeok Gyohwa Gibonwonri (Fundamental Principles of Proselytization and Edification), "Yeonhyeok Gaeyo" (Historical Overview).

(Bodhisattvas) gathered and appealed to the Gucheon (Ninth Heaven) regarding this calamity (劫厄) of the human race and the realm of divine beings (神明界) ... (Omitted)...⁷⁸⁵

Confusion manifests as the operational disorder of the Sinmyeong-gye (Realm of Divine Beings). The confusion of the Sinmyeong-gye (Realm of Divine Beings) develops into the disorder (錯亂) of the Sinmyeong-gye. It is said that the confusion of the Cheongye (Heavenly Realm) begins with the disorder of the Myeongbu (Underworld). "Sangje said, 'Because of the disorder of the Myeongbu (Underworld), the entire world has fallen into disorder; when the Myeongbu Gongsa (Work of the Underworld) is concluded, all the world's affairs will be resolved.'" After saying this, Sangje wrote on paper daily and then burned it. In this passage, the divine beings are not only the cause of the confusion but also the means of resolving the problem. Gucheon (the Ninth Heaven Sangje) diagnoses the confusion of the Sinmyeong-gye (Realm of Divine Beings) through the Samgye Daesoon (Great Circuit of the Three Realms) and corrects the confusion of the Sinmyeong-gye through the Samgye Gongsa (Works of the Three Realms). "Daesoon Jinri" (Truth of Daesoon) is an abbreviation for "Samgye Gaebyeok Daesoon Jinri" (Truth of the Great Circuit for the Gaebyeok of the Three Realms).⁷⁸⁶

The term Daesoon, literally 'Great Itineration,' by which this religious order is named Daesoon Jinrihoe, comes from The Canonical Scripture, where Sangje said:

"...all the divine sages, buddhas, and bodhisattvas, who had existed since the dawn of time, gathered and petitioned Me in the Ninth Heaven to save the realm of humans and the realm of gods from the catastrophes that they were facing. Thus, I descended to the Tower of Heavenly Revelation in the Kingdom of the Great Law (Daebeopguk 大法國) in the West, and on My Great Itineration (Daesoon 大巡) throughout the whole world, at last I reached this land in the East." (Progress of the Order 1-9)⁷⁸⁷

"Descending to the Tower of Heavenly Revelation in the Kingdom of the Great Law in the West, I went on My Great Itineration throughout the whole world to create an earthly paradise and save humanity from the verge of annihilation by re-creating the Three Realms through My great authority." (Authority and Foreknowledge 1-11)⁷⁸⁸

"Gong-Wu attended to Sangje in many Reordering Works of Heaven and Earth for three years. Whenever a Reordering Work was done, Sangje ordered, 'Make the rounds and promulgate the news to disciples everywhere.' Gong-Wu heard Him say, 'This is precisely the Great Itineration (Daesoon 大巡) around Heaven and Earth.'" (Progress of the Order 1-64) The order's name was coined by citing this

⁷⁸⁵ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gyoun" (Progress of the Order) 1-9.

⁷⁸⁶ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gongsa" (Reordering Works) 1-5.

⁷⁸⁷ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gyoun" (Progress of the Order) 1-9.

⁷⁸⁸ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gwonji" (Authority and Foreknowledge) 1-11.

Daesoon, which embodies the meaning of the Reordering Works of the Great Opening throughout the Three Realms (Samgye Daesoon Gaebyeok-gongsa).⁷⁸⁹⁷⁹⁰

In the examples above, the expression "the Daesoon (大巡) which holds the meaning of the Reordering Works of Samgye Daesoon (三界大巡, Great Itineration of the Three Realms)" shows that "Daesoon Jinri" (Daesoon Truth) is an abbreviation for "Samgye Gaebyeok Daesoon Jinri" (The Truth of the Great Itineration for the Gaebyeok of the Three Realms).

Third, as indicated by the term "Gye (界)," the Samgye (Three Realms), compared to the Eastern Samjae (Three Powers) that emphasizes attributes, emphasizes Western substantiality. The Gucheon of Daesoon Thought holds the Samgye Daegwon (Great Authority over the Three Realms), performs the Samgye Gongsa (Works of the Three Realms) which Samgye Gaejo (reorganizes) the Samgye Bokma (Latent Devils of the Three Realms), Samgye Haema (resolves the malign forces of the Three Realms), makes the Three Realms transparent, and brings about the Gaebyeok (Re-creation) of the Three Realms.⁷⁹¹ First, the Three Realms, unlike the Three Powers which are biased toward the meaning of attributes, possess substance, such as the Great Authority over the Three Realms, thereby bringing about substantial change.⁷⁹²⁷⁹³⁷⁹⁴⁷⁹⁵⁷⁹⁶⁷⁹⁷

One day, Sangje said to Kim Hyeong-ryeol, "Presiding over the great authority of the Three Realms (Samgye-daegwon), I intend to open the Hucheon Seon'gyeong (Immortal Realm of the Later World) by opening Heaven and Earth through Jhwa (Creation/Harmony) and widely save the sentient beings who have fallen into the sea of suffering (Gohae)," and also said:

"Now, facing the Malse (End Times), the Mugeuk-daeun (Great Fortune of the Ultimate Infinite) is about to open,"

"Be careful in all matters, do not create Cheok (grievances/karmic debts) with others, and distance yourselves from sin,"

"Participate in the Cheonji Gongjeong (Public Court of Heaven and Earth) with a pure mind."

⁷⁸⁹ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gyoun" (Progress of the Order) 1-64.

⁷⁹⁰ Daesoon Jinrihoe Yeolam (Daesoon Jinrihoe Overview), "Daesoon Jinrihoe."

⁷⁹¹ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Yeosi" (Prophetic Elucidations) 17; Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gwonji" (Authority and Foreknowledge) 1-21.

⁷⁹² Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Haengrok" (Acts) 5-38.

⁷⁹³ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Yeosi" (Prophetic Elucidations) 7.

⁷⁹⁴ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gongsa" (Reordering Works) 1-3.

⁷⁹⁵ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gyoun" (Progress of the Order) 1-30.

⁷⁹⁶ Daesoon Jinrihoe Yeolam (Daesoon Jinrihoe Overview), p.9.

⁷⁹⁷ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gongsa" (Reordering Works) 1-2.

So He spoke, and He opened Hyeong-ryeol's Sinan (divine eye) and had him observe the Hoesan (gathering and scattering) and Cheongryeong (receiving commands) of the divine beings.⁷⁹⁸

In the example above, Gucheon mentions the Great Authority over the Three Realms as the means to re-create Heaven and Earth through Johwa via the divine beings and to open the Earthly Paradise of the Later World. Through the divine beings, Gucheon can also resolve the malign forces (Haema) of the Bokma (Latent Devils), the hidden demons of the Three Realms, and bring about Gaebyeok.

The introduction of the Shinmyeonggye and the harmony of substance and attribute through the concept of the Three Realms can be explained more concretely by the incarnation of Gucheon in Daesoon Thought and the subsequent harmony of the views of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity, compared to Donghak Thought which only emphasized the appearance of the Cheonoicheon. Against the backdrop of the concept of the Three Realms examined above, we can compare the indigenous modernity manifested in Donghak Thought and Daesoon Thought.

First, the characteristics of Donghak Thought's views of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity can be summarized as follows. First, Donghak Thought activated the concept of Cheonju (Heavenly Lord), a being outside the Heavenly Realm. The Donghak view of Heaven is different from the pre-Donghak view of Heaven, which was merely separate. Second, the Donghak view of Heaven formally possesses both the transcendence of Seohak (Western Learning) and the immanence of Daoism, and content-wise, it possesses the immanence of Seohak and the transcendence of Daoism. Regarding the view of Earth, Donghak Thought also aims for an Earthly Paradise. Examining the Donghak view of Humanity, it advocates Boguganmin (Protecting the Nation and Securing Peace for the People). This is based on the harmony between Earth and Humanity, and the harmony between humans.

Throughout the East and West, claims and ideas regarding the views of Humanity and the Divine have continuously emerged. However, Daesoon Thought is almost the only ideology that has re-established the view of the Three Realms (Samgyegwan) and re-established the views of the Divine and Humanity through this worldview. As Daesoon Thought's re-establishment of the view of the Three Realms was different from existing religions, research on the view of the Three Realms has been very rare.

The Eastern worldview of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity is no longer a worldview that even Easterners believe in and rely on today, following the Western invasions that occurred over 100 years ago. The negation of the views of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity means the negation of Eastern civilization and the negation of the 5,000-year history that the East has achieved. Therefore, the re-establishment of the views of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity is the re-establishment of Eastern civilization and the revival of Eastern history.

In response to the changed views of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity in Donghak Thought, Daesoon Thought presents the concept of the Three Realms. The Three Realms not only have ancient origins but

⁷⁹⁸ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Yeosi" (Prophetic Elucidations) 17.

also provide a microscopic framework for East Asian culture as a whole, beyond just a macroscopic worldview. The Three Realms surpassed the spatial worldview of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity to become the basis for the methodology of Eumyang Ohaeng (Yin-Yang and the Five Elements), which formed the foundation of East Asian philosophy, religion, science, art, and technology. The Samjae (Three Powers) provided a unified framework, from high culture to folk culture, as the common foundation for the theories of Yin-Yang and the Five Elements.

The worldview of Daesoon Thought is characterized as the Samgyegwan (View of the Three Realms). Daesoon Thought is almost the only religion that clearly presents the Samgyegwan as its worldview. In Daesoon Thought, the Three Realms refer to the Heavenly Realm (Cheon-gye), the Earthly Realm (Ji-gye), and the Human Realm (In-gye). Although Daoist thought individually mentions the Celestial Realm, the Subterranean Realm, etc., instances of using the expression "Three Realms" to refer to them collectively are rare. On the other hand, Daesoon Thought presupposes the "Three Realms" starting from the term Daesoon itself, and the Cheonjigongsa (Reordering Works of Heaven and Earth), which is central to Daesoon Thought, is also expressed as a series of Samgye Gongsa (Works of the Three Realms).

The denominations that advocate correlative thinking are those that venerate Jeungsan as their object of faith, and among them, Daesoon Thought is the most representative. The Daesoon denomination further specifies and emphasizes the Three Realms. Daesoon Thought also made the establishment of the Samgyegwan the foremost task of the Cheonjigongsa and assigned it priority theoretically as well. The establishment of the Samgyegwan in Daesoon Thought is liminality and revitalization based on correlative thinking, and can be described as Eumyang Hapdeok (Virtuous Concordance of Yin and Yang), Samjae Hwangnip (Establishment of the Three Powers), and Ohaeng Gubi (Completion of the Five Elements). In the Cheonjigongsa, this is actually implemented in Heaven, Earth, and Humanity.

The most concrete form of Gaebyeok (Re-creation) is the Samgye Gaebyeok (Re-creation of the Three Realms) of Daesoon. Before Jeungsan spoke of Samgye Gaebyeok, there was "Dasi Gaebyeok" (Re-creation Again), but Samgye Gaebyeok is clear and substantial. Although there has been much research on Donghak, comparative studies with Daesoon Thought regarding the views of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity are rare. The comparison between Donghak Thought and Daesoon Thought is most clearly revealed in the changes in their views of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity.

Despite the widespread examples of the Three Realms in East Asian culture, the understanding of the Three Realms is still insufficient, not only within Daesoon Thought itself but also in the entire study of Eastern thought. The reason research on the Three Realms is insufficient is that the concept of the Three Realms requires empirical and logical explanation. This is a field of interdisciplinary research that transcends the domain of the humanities. In other words, the extensive scope possessed by the Three Realms has actually acted as an obstacle. Because the Three Realms are not merely a symbolic framework but are applied to substantial culture, explaining the infinite domain possessed by the Three Realms often

did not align with existing Western science. Therefore, in the study of East Asian thought, the Three Realms as a worldview were regarded as a pre-modern worldview, and only the ideological aspects have been studied separately.

The views of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity in Daesoon Thought, which interpret Cheon-Ji-In (Heaven, Earth, Humanity) as the Three Realms, superficially align with the Daoist views of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity. The Three Realms in Daoism is a concept established by expanding the concept of Jae (才, Power/Component) from the Samjae (Three Powers) of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity into the concept of Gye (界, Realm) as in Segye (World). The Three Realms in the East are largely divided into the Buddhist Three Realms (composed of the Desire Realm, Form Realm, and Formless Realm) and the Daoist Heavenly Realm, Earthly Realm, and Human Realm. The Daoist views of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity, which clearly explain the material world, and the Buddhist view of the Three Realms, which is also understood as a spiritual state, seem to have clear differences in their explanatory fields, but they also show commonalities. Among the commonalities, looking first at the name "Three Realms," the concept of "Gye" (Realm)—as in Heavenly Realm, Earthly Realm, and Human Realm—appears in Daoism after the Buddhist concept of the Three Realms, instead of Samjae (Three Powers). Also, regarding the division of heavens, the heavens appearing in the Buddhist Three Realms add up to 28 heavens, and Daoism also has 28 heavens, excluding the upper heavens. The fact that the number of heavens, 28, matches, shows that Daoism's expression of the Samjae as "Gye" (Realms) like the Buddhist Three Realms indicates that the Daoist Heavenly, Earthly, and Human Realms and the Buddhist Three Realms share commonalities. Another commonality in the "Gye" concept of Buddhism and Daoism is the application of tri-divisional thinking in world perception.⁷⁹⁹

The tri-division in both Buddhism and Daoism seems to be an emphasis on the mechanical symmetry common to both Buddhism and Daoism. Symmetry itself is a binary division of Yin and Yang, but sustaining symmetry requires a new central axis at the center of the two axes. Just like natural phenomena in the macroscopic solar system or the microscopic subatomic particle system, metaphysical thought also requires three axes to finally maintain continuous symmetry. Like the global ubiquity of the concept of the Trinity, the reason why the worldview of tri-division is universal throughout the world, not just in the East but across all ages and places, is clearly the maintenance of symmetry. This is also a characteristic of the Samgyegwan (View of the Three Realms) of Daesoon Thought, which has Eumyang Hapdeok (Virtuous Concordance of Yin and Yang) as its tenet. Another reason the Daoist views of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity, which align with the Samgyegwan of Daesoon Thought, receive attention is because of their

⁷⁹⁹ Park Tae-bong, "Hangug-ui Sasang-gwa Munhwa-e Natanan Samsu Wolli Yeongu" [A Study on the Principle of Three Numbers Appearing in Korean Thought and Culture], Kongju National University Doctoral Dissertation, 2020.

scientific nature. In particular, the fractal worldview of quantum mechanics, which views the universe as a repetition of a single principle, has been highlighted by new scientists like Capra since the 1960s.⁸⁰⁰

Seoncheon (Former World) and Hucheon (Later World)

The most prominent difference seen in the view of Heaven between Donghak Thought and Daesoon Thought can be succinctly described as Seoncheon (Former World) and Hucheon (Later World). Like the difference between the Three Realms and the Three Powers, Seoncheon and Hucheon do not just signify a simple difference in eras, but are a core concept related to whether or not the Shinmyeong (Divine Beings) play a role in modernity. The concept of the Hucheon is distinguished from the Seoncheon based on the incarnation of Sangje as a human body. The appearance of the Cheonoicheon (Heaven beyond Heaven) in Donghak Thought and the incarnation of Gucheon (Ninth Heaven) as a human body in Daesoon Thought represent an incomparable difference from the perspective of the Shinmyeonggye (Realm of Divine Beings) that constitutes the world; therefore, the boundary of the Hucheon begins with the incarnation of Gucheon in Daesoon Thought, which brings about a total change in the status of the Shinmyeonggye and the Ingye (Human Realm). Therefore, the concept of Hucheon in Daesoon Thought is an expression unique to Daesoon Thought, completely different from the Jeongyeok (Correct Change) thought.

In Donghak Thought, Gaebyeok (Re-creation) becomes "Dasi Gaebyeok" (Re-creation Again), which carries the meaning of "Returning to the Seoncheon." The "Dasi Gaebyeok" of Donghak Thought has often been interpreted as "Hucheon Gaebyeok" (Re-creation of the Later World). However, looking at the records of Donghak-related denominations that continued Donghak Thought, "Dasi Gaebyeok" appears to be a return to the origin point of the Seoncheon, "Doro Seoncheon" (Returning to the Seoncheon), rather than meaning "Hucheon Gaebyeok." "Doro Seoncheon" seems to be a term formally similar to "Dasi Gaebyeok." 'Sangju Donghak,' which used the term "Doro Seoncheon," is known as a denomination that newly distributed many Donghak-related scriptures and Gasa (verses). The fact that this denomination, which focused on publishing and literature, interpreted "Dasi Gaebyeok" as "Doro Seoncheon" seems to indicate their position that, in the context of the Donghak scriptures, "Dasi Gaebyeok" is properly interpreted as "Doro Seoncheon." In fact, if one looks at the problems of that time only from a Confucian perspective, the best solution to the problems of the time could be a "Dasi Gaebyeok" that returns to the age of Yao and Shun.⁸⁰¹

On the other hand, Daesoon thought advocates for Huchon Gaebyeok in response to this. The concepts of Sonchon and Huchon also follow the principle of liminality, where ontogeny repeats phylogeny, so a

⁸⁰⁰ Fritjof Capra, trans. Kim Yong-jeong and Kim Dong-gwang, *Saengmyeong-ui Geumul: Saengmul Siseutem-e Daehan Saeroun Gwahakjeok Ihae* (The Web of Life: A New Scientific Understanding of Living Systems), Seoul: Goyang, 1998.; Fritjof Capra, trans. Yi Seong-beom and Kim Yong-jeong, *Hyeondae Mulli-hak-gwa Dongyang Sasang* (The Tao of Physics), Goyang: Beomyangsa, 2015.

⁸⁰¹ Kim Tak, "Donghakgyo 'Doro Seoncheon' (先天) Sasang-ui Naeyong-gwa Uiui" [The Content and Significance of the Donghak Religion's Thought of 'Returning to the Former Heaven'], *Daesoon Sasang Nonchong* (Journal of Daesoon Thought) 48, 2024, pp.199-237.

comparison with the Sonchon of Donghak thought can be made by examining the characteristics of the Huchon. The Huchon is a view of Heaven (Cheongwan) in which the Eastern attributive view of Heaven and the Western substantive view of Heaven have achieved virtuous concordance (Hapdeok). From the perspective of Daesoon thought, which integrates Confucianism, Buddhism, and Daoism (Yubulseon), the idea of "Doro-Sonchon," meaning the era of Yao and Shun begins again, is a reductionist understanding of Daesoon thought through the lens of Confucian limitations (Yugyo-ui Jeonheon).

Upon entering the twelfth month, Sangje completed various Gongsas (Works) and embarked on the Gongsas to adjust the Yeokdo (degrees of rebellion/adversity). Gyeong-seok, Gwang-chan, and Nae-seong left for Daeheung-ri; Won-il left for Shin Gyeong-won's house; and Hyeong-ryeol and Ja-hyeon left for Donggok. Sangje spoke to the remaining Mun Gong-sin, Hwang Eung-jong, and Shin Gyeong-su, saying, "Gyeong-seok's Seong (Sincerity), Gyeong (Reverence), and Sin (Trust) are so profound that I considered using him differently, but since this is a matter he himself requests, it cannot be helped," and added, "Originally, Donghak's advocacy for Boguk-anmin (protecting the nation and securing peace for the people) was merely a cry for the work of the Later World, but their hearts each desired to become 'kings, marquises, generals, and ministers,' and tens of thousands were dragged away and killed without achieving their desire. Their grievances soared to the heavens, and if those divine beings were left as they are, the governance of the Later World would fall into adversity (Yeokdo) and become chaotic; therefore, I was in the process of appointing a leader for the Haewon (resolution of grievances) of those divine beings, and Gyeong-seok's mention of twelve empires (十二帝國) means he has volunteered for it. His father was a high-ranking leader in Donghak and was captured and killed, and he himself also served as a Donghak Chongdae (representative leader), so from now on, I have attached all the Donghak divine beings to Gyeong-seok; from this seat, the Haewon of the 'kings, marquises, generals, and ministers' shall begin," He said, writing on a piece of paper, forbidding outsiders from entering, and saying, "Watch in the days to come. The expenditure of money will greatly increase, and the number of people will also be greater than in the Gabo year (1894). They must be set free so that there will be no hindrance in the Later World," He concluded.⁸⁰²

The original intent of Donghak thought was the Huchon, but Donghak thought, understanding Daesoon thought through the limitations of Confucianism, misunderstood the Huchon as 'Doro-Sonchon' (Returning to the Former World) and understood Donghak thought as the idea of "the whole country becoming Yangban (aristocrats)." Furthermore, the dream of "Yangban" connects to becoming 'Wanghujangsang,' which shows that the interpretation of "Doro-Sonchon" was an incomplete interpretation.

Like the principle that phylogeny is recapitulated in ontogeny, Daesoon Thought holds that the new era is realized in a new world through a new thought that integrates Confucianism, Buddhism, and Daoism,

⁸⁰² Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gongsas" (Reordering Works) 2-19.

and that this had to be the Later World (Hucheon)—a new Heaven and new Earth—rather than a reverting Former World (Seoncheon).

In Daesoon thought, the Sonchon was not a world to be sublated (rejected) in contrast to the Huchon, but a process that had to be passed through according to the principle of Saengjang-yeomjang (growth, flourishing, harvest, storage) in order to reach the Huchon. The countless grievances of the Sonchon were the driving force that could be resolved through Haewon in the Huchon. However, the meaning of Gaebyeok, or the indigenous modernity of Daesoon thought, was not that the Sonchon would be reset to the beginning like 'Doro-Sonchon.' The Gaebyeok and Huchon that the indigenous modernity of Daesoon thought sought to achieve was a new world created by gathering only the advantages of the principles of all times and places, just as ontogeny repeats phylogeny.⁸⁰³

Originally, the term 'Sonchon' (Prior Heaven) was first used in the history of I-Ching (Yeok) studies by Shao Kangjie (Sogangjeol), and the scholarly system of Sonchon-yeokhak (Prior Heaven I-Ching studies) was completed by Zhu Xi (Ju Hui) and Cai Yuanding (Chae Wonjeong), the father of Cai Chen (Chae Chim) who wrote the "Seojeon-seomun" (Preface to the Book of Documents).⁸⁰⁴ Sonchon-yeokhak, unlike the I-Ching studies that tell fortunes according to King Mun's 64 hexagrams, is the study that explores the principles of universal change appearing in Fuxi's 8 trigrams diagram and the Hado (River Map) and Nakseo (Luo Writing). The commonly used Fuxi's 8 trigrams diagram did not exist before Shao Kangjie made it public. In Sonchon-yeokhak, 'Sonchon' is used to mean "prior to Heaven" in the I-Ching, referring to the time before things operated in mutual conflict (Sangguk) or before matter came into existence. Shao Kangjie distinguishes between Sonchon (Prior) and Huchon (Latter) worlds based on the boundary of Emperor Yao's discovery of the concept of 'To' (Earth). Since Sonchon-yeokhak is related to the arrangement of the eight trigrams, "Jeongyeok" (Correct Change) can also be considered Sonchon-yeokhak in a broad sense. For the modern interpretation of Sonchon-yeokhak, Han Gyu-seong, Han Tae-dong, Han Jang-gyeong, Han Dong-seok, Lee Seung-su, Kim Seung-ho, Yu Nam-sang, Lee Hyeon-jung, Im Byeong-hak, Yun Jong-bin, and Kim Sang-il are widely known.⁸⁰⁵⁸⁰⁶⁸⁰⁷⁸⁰⁸⁸⁰⁹⁸¹⁰⁸¹¹¹⁸¹²⁸¹³⁸¹⁴⁸¹⁵

⁸⁰³ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Yeosi" (Prophetic Elucidations) 30.

⁸⁰⁴ Jo Hui-yeong, "Seo Myeong-eung-ui Seoncheon Yeokhak Jeongnim-gwa Sidae-jeok Uiui; 'Seoncheon Saryeon'-eul Jungsim-euro" [The Establishment of Seo Myeong-eung's Former-Heaven I Ching Studies and Its Historical Significance: Centering on 'Seoncheon Saryeon'], *Cheolhak Yeongu* (Philosophical Research) 98, 2012, p.1.

⁸⁰⁵ Han Gyu-seong, original author; Han Pil-hun, ed., *Juyeok-e Daehan 46gaji Jilmun-gwa Daedap* (46 Questions and Answers on the I Ching), Dongnyeok, 1996; Han Gyu-seong, *Yeokhak Wonri Ganghwa* (Lectures on the Principles of I Ching Studies), Yemun-ji, 1997.

⁸⁰⁶ Han Tae-dong, *Sayu-ui Heulleum* (The Flow of Thought), Yonsei University Press, 2003.

⁸⁰⁷ Han Jang-gyeong, *Juyeok-Jeongyeok* (The I Ching and the Correct Changes), Salm-gwa Kkum, 2001.

⁸⁰⁸ Han Dong-seok, *Uju Byeonhwa-ui Wonri: Eumyang Ohaeng Wonri* (The Principles of Cosmic Change: The Principles of Yin-Yang and the Five Elements), Daewon Publishing, 2003.

⁸⁰⁹ Lee Seung-soo, *The Principle of Jung* (Center/Balance), Seoul: GG.com, 2008.

⁸¹⁰ Kim Seung-ho, *Juyeok Wonron* (The Original Principles of the I Ching) (vols. 1-6), Seonyeongsa, 2009.

⁸¹¹ Yun Jong-bin, *Jeongyeok-gwa Juyeok* (The Correct Changes and the I Ching), Sangsaeng Publishing, 2009.

The concept of Huchon begins with the use of the concept of Cheonju (Lord of Heaven) in Donghak thought. This is because what separates Sonchon and Huchon is the incarnation of Sangje into a human body. 'Cheonju' (Lord of Heaven) is the name of the monotheistic God that Matteo Ricci heard from a young Chinese man.⁸¹⁶ Catholic priests and Protestant ministers who studied Confucian scriptures, including Matteo Ricci, say that the Sangje of primitive Confucianism had a purely monotheistic form.⁸¹⁷ Matteo Ricci, the Catholic priest who first introduced Seohak (Western Learning/Catholicism) to China, and James Legge (1815-1897), the Protestant minister who translated the Four Books and Five Classics including the "I Ching" (Juyeok) and "Analects" (Noneo) into Western languages, almost identically claimed that the Chinese were descendants of Noah who had migrated, thus possessing primitive monotheistic beliefs which later became corrupted.⁸¹⁸ Terrien de Lacouperie (1844-1894), Europe's foremost Sinologist until the early 20th century, also argued that the Yellow Emperor (Huangdi) came from Babylonia.⁸¹⁹

The 'Cheonju' in the Sichonju (Serving the Lord of Heaven) incantation is important because the reason for the persecution of Donghak was the suspicion that Donghak was Catholicism, based on the 'Cheonju' in the 'Sichonju' incantation. Why Choe Su-un insisted on 'Cheonju', even knowing the danger that the 'Cheonju' in the 'Sichonju' incantation could lead to Donghak being persecuted as Catholicism, remains an unsolved riddle in academia. Choe Su-un received the teachings of Sangje as a revelation, and Sichonju was also a revelation from Sangje; thus, although there was concern he could be persecuted as a Catholic, he could not change it. 'Cheonju' in 'Sichonju' also signified Mireuk (Maitreya), the Lord of Tushita Heaven, who appears in the Mireuk-sangsaeng-gyeong (Sutra on the Upward Rebirth of Maitreya). The reason Matteo Ricci translated Deus as Cheonju was not because he invented the term, but because it

⁸¹² Yi Hyeon-jung, *Yeokyeong-gwa Saseo* (The Book of Changes and the Four Books), Yeongnak, 2004.

⁸¹³ Im Byeong-hak, *Yeokhak-gwa Hado Nakseo* (I Ching Studies and the River Chart and Luo Writing), Korea Academic Information, 2008.

⁸¹⁴ Yun Jong-bin, *Hanguk Yeokhak Yeongu-ui Gicho* (Foundations of Korean I Ching Research), Mungyeong Publishing, 2012.

⁸¹⁵ Kim Sang-il, *Yeok-gwa Talhyeondae-ui Nonri* (The I Ching and the Logic of Postmodernity), Jisiksaneopsa, 2006.

⁸¹⁶ An Seong-ho, "The Theological Continuity between the Term 'Shangdi (上帝)' Used in Matteo Ricci's Tianzhu Shiyi (early 17th century) and James Legge's English Translations of Chinese Confucian Classics (19th century)," *Hanguk Gidokgyo-wa Yeoksa* (Christianity and History in Korea) 32, Korea Institute of Christian History, 2010, pp.302-304.; Chen Kai Tong, *Godae Jungguk Sok-ui Hananim* (God in Ancient China), Seoul: Sun Publishing, 2009.

⁸¹⁷ An Seong-ho, "John Ross's Theological Stance on Primitive Chinese Confucian Monotheism and the Terminology Debate in Chinese Bible Translation," *Hanguk Gidokgyo-wa Yeoksa* (Christianity and History in Korea) 40, (Korea Institute of Christian History, 2014), p.228.

⁸¹⁸ Legge, *The Notions of the Chinese concerning God and Spirits*, p.33, cited in An Seong-ho, "The Theological Continuity between the Term 'Shangdi (上帝)' Used in Matteo Ricci's Tianzhu Shiyi and James Legge's English Translations of Chinese Confucian Classics," *Hanguk Gidokgyo-wa Yeoksa* (Christianity and History in Korea) 32, Korea Institute of Christian History, 2010, pp.315-316.

⁸¹⁹ Sun Jiang, "The Yellow Emperor Came from Babylon: Lacouperie's Theory of the Western Origin of Chinese Civilization and Its Spread to East Asia," *Gaenyeom-gwa Sotong* (Concepts and Communication) 5, 2010, pp.79-26.

was the term used to mean God in China at the time.⁸²⁰ The Huchon was a concept contrasted with the Yonghwa-segye (Dragon-Flower World) that comes after the descent of Maitreya (Mireuk).⁸²¹

In Daesoon thought, the Huchon is a view of the Samgye (Three Realms) in which the Samjae (Three Powers/Potencies) are established. The Daesoon view of the Cheongyegwan (Heavenly Realm), which establishes the Samjae, even reorganizes the astronomy (Cheonmun) of the heavens. Daesoon reifies Mugeuk (the Ultimate Non-being/Limitless) through the concept of Mugeuksin (God of Mugeuk) and reifies Taegeuk (the Supreme Ultimate) through Tae-eul Cheonsang-wongun (Primal Lord of the Tae-eul Heaven). The Huchon is the future view of the Heavenly Realm, into which the Sinmyeong (spirits/gods) are introduced, seen from the perspective of the Guchon (Ninth Heaven). The view of the Heavenly Realm in the Huchon is as follows.

First, the Daesoon concept of the Heavenly Realm appears as two concepts of the Heavenly Realm. Cheon (Heaven) as Sangje is newly added. In Daesoon thought, there are two Gods: God as Sangje and the Cheonjisinmyeong (Spirits of Heaven and Earth); thus, there is the Heaven of Taegeuk (Supreme Ultimate) which contrasts with the Earth, and there is the Taegeuk Heaven above that, which integrates Heaven and Earth. Sangje presides over both Mugeuk and Taegeuk.

Second, compared to Donghak thought, which merely declared that Heaven and Earth are Yin and Yang, the Ibeopcheon (Heaven of Principle/Law) is more concretized in Daesoon thought. In summary, the characteristics of the Daesoon view of the Heavenly Realm appear as a more concrete view of the Heavenly Realm than that of Donghak thought, including: the replacement of the old heaven with a new heaven, an emphasis on Taegeuk and principle (Ichi), the distinction between the grace of Heaven and the principle of Earth, and the relationship of Yin-Yang virtuous concordance (Eumyang-hapdeok) between Heaven and Earth.

The correlative thinking appearing in the Donghak view of the Heavenly Realm is limited compared to that of Daesoon thought. The fact that the Cheon-In (Heaven-Human) relationship and the Cheon-Ji (Heaven-Earth) relationship are more prominent in the Daesoon view of the Heavenly Realm shows that liminality aspects are strengthened in the Daesoon view of the Heavenly Realm more than in Donghak thought. Furthermore, the Daesoon view of the Heavenly Realm emphasizes Sangsaeng (Mutual

⁸²⁰ Hundreds of thousands of heavenly beings provided celestial music while scattering heavenly mandala flowers and great mandala flowers above him, praising: 'Excellent, excellent! Good man, because you cultivated abundant meritorious karma in Jambudvipa, you have been born here. This place is called Tusita Heaven, and the Lord of Heaven (Cheonju) here is named Maitreya; you should take refuge in him.' (Foshuo Guan Mile Pusa Shang Sheng Dou Shuai Tian Jing [Sutra on Contemplating Bodhisattva Maitreya's Ascent to Tusita Heaven]: 百千天子作天伎樂持天曼陀羅花摩訶曼陀羅花以散其上讚言善哉善哉善男子汝於閻浮提廣修福業來生此處此處名兜率陀天今此天主名曰彌勒汝當歸依, Dongguk University Buddhist Records Cultural Heritage Archive). Gucheon Daewon Johwajusin can also be called Cheonju (Lord of Heaven) by combining the cheon of Gucheon and the ju of Johwaju.

⁸²¹ Choe Jong-seok, "Buddhist Elements in Jeungsan Religion: Focusing on the Acceptance of Maitreya Faith," Seonmunhwa Yeongu (Research on Seon Culture) 23, 2017, pp.254-255.

Beneficence), which does not appear in Donghak thought, and the role of Heaven is redefined, expanding revitalization in Daesoon thought.

In Daesoon thought, the revitalized view of the Heavenly Realm is reified as Mugeuksin (God of Mugeuk) and Tae-eul Cheonsang-wongun (Primal Lord of the Tae-eul Heaven); the arrangement of the Chilseongju (Lords of the Seven Stars) is changed; and the names of spirits are invoked in the 24 Ju (Jurisdictions/Divisions) and 28 Su (Constellations/Mansions), thereby re-establishing the view of the Heavenly Realm. This is realized through the Myeongbu-gongsa (Reordering Work of the Netherworld) within the Cheonji-gongsa (Reordering Works of Heaven and Earth). The astronomy of the Cheonsang-bunya-yeolcha-jido (Celestial Chart) is realigned.

In Daesoon thought, the Gaebyeok (Opened) Huchon signifies the fusion of all principles that have appeared in the time and space of all ages, East and West. Therefore, the connection of Eastern and Western views of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity appearing in the Johwa (Harmony/Creation) of Donghak thought develops into fusion through the Samgye-gongsa (Reordering Work of the Three Realms) in Daesoon thought.

The Mueui-ihwa (Spontaneous Transformation) of the Cheon-Ji relationship in Donghak thought, which consists of Naeyu-sinryeong (Indwelling Spirit) and Oeyu-gihwa (Externalized Ki-transformation), appears in Daesoon thought as the Sa-ui (Four Forms/Modes) of Saengjang-yeomjang (growth, flourishing, harvest, storage). As a result of the reorganization of the 28 Su (Constellations) and 24 Jeolhu (Solar Terms) through the Cheonji-gongsa, the harmony of the 10 Gan (Stems) and 12 Ji (Branches), Wonhyeong-ijeong (Primal, Flourishing, Advantageous, Firm), and the 12 Unseong (Phases of Fortune) is established in Daesoon thought. This appears in the order of Eumyang-hapdeok (Virtuous Concordance of Yin and Yang), Samjae-hwakrip (Establishment of the Three Powers), and Ohaeng-gubi (Completion of the Five Elements), as shown in the Mugeukdo-chwijiseo (Statement of Purpose of Mugeukdo) of Daesoon thought.

However, existing views of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity (Cheongwan, Jigwan, Ingwan) had fixed, unbalanced, and incompatible relationships between Heaven, Earth, and Humanity, and thus mainly pursued human salvation, liberation from suffering, or human immortality, but failed to pursue the realization of the world-spirit by humans. The existing views of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity still carry the unresolved homework that Western civilization failed to solve when it spread to the East in the past. What differentiates the Daesoon view of the Three Realms (Samgye-gwan) from existing views of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity is the variability, constancy, and compatibility of the Three Realms. The Daesoon view of the Three Realms possesses variability, constancy, and compatibility through Sangje.

The perspective of viewing modern problems as problems of the traditional Three Realms is not found even in Daoism. The reason Daesoon thought still shines today, over 100 years later, is that even now, there are few cases that have diagnosed modern civilization from a traditional Eastern perspective as much as

Daesoon thought has. A differentiated study is needed on the perspective that viewed the problems of modernity from the viewpoint of the senescence and imbalance of the Three Realms.

Comparative Study on the Indigenous Modernity of the View of Earth (Jigwan)

Gihwa (Ki-transformation) and Jori (Governing/Conditioning)

In Donghak thought and Daesoon thought, which define the views of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity from the perspective of the Transcendent Heaven (Chowolcheon), 'Earth' (Ddang) is not the Earth belonging to the conventional Heaven-and-Earth (Cheonji), but rather the concept of Heaven-and-Earth contrasted with the Transcendent Heaven, namely Gihwa (Ki-transformation). However, in the case of Daesoon thought, which introduced the concept of Sinmyeong (spirits/gods) to Donghak thought, the role of Jori (Governing/Conditioning) by the incarnated Transcendent Heaven—that is, the role of 'To' (Earth) as a mediator—is added to the concept of Gihwa. The concept of Jori in Daesoon thought also follows the principle of liminality that ontogeny repeats phylogeny, allowing a comparison of the views of Earth (Jigwan) in Donghak thought and Daesoon thought through the concept of Jori appearing in Daesoon thought. Jori is a concept that clearly shows the Daesoon view of the Earthly Realm (Jigyegwan), which is harmonized by the World of Spirits (Sinmyeonggye), in contrast to Donghak thought.

天用地用 人用之 調理綱紀 統制乾坤 此之謂造化手段也⁸²²

The above example shows that Jori, corresponding to Gihwa, is a core principle explaining the operation of the universe, just as Gihwa is. The 'Ri' (or 'I') in Jori is expressed as principle (Ichi) or law/principle (Ibeop). In Daesoon thought, the Earth appears as the central being of principle.

On the 23rd day of the twelfth lunar month of the Jeongmi year, Sangje visited Shin Gyeong-su at his house. Sangje spoke about Yao's "observing the sun, moon, and stars, and respectfully bestowing the seasons upon the people" (yeoksang ilwolseongsin gyeongsuinsi), saying, "Heaven and Earth, without the sun and moon, are an empty shell; the sun and moon, without a person of wisdom (ji-in), are an empty shadow. Because Dang Yao (Emperor Yao) discerned the laws of the sun and moon and taught them to the people, the grace of Heaven and the principles of Earth were finally bestowed upon humanity." At this time, Sangje taught, "The sun and moon govern all things without selfishness; the rivers and mountains have the Dao and receive hundreds of practices (日月無私治萬物 江山有道受百行)," and He composed the Five

⁸²² Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Jesaeng" (Saving Lives) 43. The use of Heaven (Cheon-yong), the use of Earth (Ji-yong), and the use of Humanity (In-yong) are to harmonize the fundamental order (Ganggi), thereby governing Heaven and Earth. This is called the means of Joswa (Creation/Transformation). (Yang Mu-mok, "Haewon Jinri-roseoui Eumyang Hapdeok-gwa Minjujuui" [Yin-Yang Harmonic Virtue as Salvation Truth, and Democracy], Daesoon Sasang Nonchong [Journal of Daesoon Studies] 2, 1997, pp.175-176)

Mantras (Oju), calling them the "Essence (Jinaek) of Heaven and Earth," and the Five Mantras are as follows.⁸²³

In the above example, the "principle of Earth" (Ddang-ui Ichi) shows the aspect of the Earth focusing on principle and law, according to the principle of Cheonwon-jibang (Heaven is round, Earth is square). Ri (Principle) traditionally appears in connection with Taegeuk (Supreme Ultimate). Before Donghak thought and Daesoon thought emerged, 'I' (Ri, principle) was the central concept in I-Gi-ron (Theory of Principle and Material Force); therefore, Donghak thought, with the concept of "Gihwa" (Ki-transformation), relatively emphasized Gi (material force) over I. In response to this, Daesoon thought emphasizes the 'I' (Principle) before 'I'—that is, Mugeuk (Limitless) and Taegeuk (Supreme Ultimate)—thereby stressing its practical application to everyday affairs.⁸²⁴

理雖高出於太極無極之表 不離乎日用事物之間⁸²⁵

In the example above, the expression "Though Principle [I] is lofty, it issues forth from Taegeuk and Mugeuk" shows that 'I' (Principle) belongs to the Guchon (Ninth Heaven) of Daesoon thought, who is the presider over Mugeuk and Taegeuk. Accordingly, 'I' (Principle) exists within everyday affairs, that is, within all things in the universe (Samra-mansang). Whereas 'I' (Principle) in I-Gi-ron (Theory of Principle and Material Force) was a concept oriented toward attributes that excluded substantiality, the 'I' appearing in the example above is a concept of 'I' that emphasizes substantiality.

Because Taegeuk is the origin of the universe, it does not exist only at the beginning or origin, but is immanent in all things, like the 'I' (Principle) of the Avatamsaka (Hwaeom) Sutra. Zhu Xi's (Juja) expression 'Gakgu-Taegeuk Tongche-Taegeuk' (Each thing possesses Taegeuk; the whole possesses Taegeuk) means that Taegeuk exists commonly in the maximal universe and the minimal universe, just as the Avatamsaka Sutra says innumerable Buddhas exist within a speck of dust. The only difference between Taegeuk and the 'I' (Principle) of Buddhism is that Taegeuk explicitly expresses that its interior is specifically composed of Yin and Yang. Another difference between the 'I' (Principle) of I-Gi-ron (Theory of Principle and Material Force) and the 'I' of the Avatamsaka Sutra is that the 'I' of I-Gi-ron manifests specific attributes known as Wonhyeong-ijeong (Primal, Flourishing, Advantageous, Firm), unlike the 'I' of the Avatamsaka Sutra.⁸²⁶

⁸²³ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gyoun" (Progress of the Order) 1-30.

⁸²⁴ It is said that Jeongeup, where Daesoon thought originated, had the tradition of Iljae Yi Hang, a substantialist school of Li-Qi thought. Kim Ik-du, Choe Yeong-seong, Yi Seon-a, Kim Beom-su, Iljae Yi Hang-ui Sasang Hangmun Iron-e Gwanhan Saeroun Sigakdeul (New Perspectives on the Thought, Scholarship, and Theory of Iljae Yi Hang), Seoul: Munyewon, 2014.

⁸²⁵ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Jesaeng" (Saving Lives) 43. Yi su go chul eo mugeuk taeguk ji pyo, bulli ho ilyong samul ji gan. Although the principle is lofty, it emerges from the surface of Taiji (the Supreme Ultimate) and Wuji (the Limitless), and does not depart from the midst of daily-use things.

⁸²⁶ Zhu Xi's expression 'Gakgu Taegeuk, Tongche Taegeuk' (各具太極, 統體太極) — each thing possessing the Supreme Ultimate, and the Supreme Ultimate as a whole — is connected to the Huayan concept of Jungjeung Mujin (重重無盡, infinite interpenetration). (Kim Jong-uk, "Bogjapgye-roseo Saengtaegye-wa Beopgye" [Ecosystem and Dharmadhatu as Complex Systems], Cheolhak Sasang [Philosophical Thought] 41, 2011, pp.7-36)

Originally, the characteristics of the category of li (理) are said to be inclusiveness, diversity, and dynamism. Examining the concept of li before Neo-Confucianism, in the *Shuowen Jiezi*, li is connected with jade (玉) in the sense that, the grain of things being densest in jade, the character follows 'jade.' Li first appears in the *Classic of Poetry* (Shijing 詩經), the *Zuozhuan*, and the *Guoyu*, where the concept of li used as munri (紋理, the pattern of markings) appears as chiri (治理, the principle of governing). Thereafter, in the *Yijing* it became the principle of all under Heaven and the principle of nature and destiny; it became Mencius's righteousness-principle and Xunzi's ritual-principle, and then changed into the Daoist principle of the natural. After that, Dong Zhongshu's concept of li and the concept of li in the *Huangdi Neijing* appeared. Dong Zhongshu, in the 'Cycle of the Dao' of the *Chunqiu Fanlu*, spoke of 'that which Heaven and Earth have not yet reached—li,' and the *Huangdi Neijing* calls birth-growth-transformation-completion-storage the 'principle of nurturing life.'⁸²⁷

The reason the characteristics of the 'Ri' (Principle) category were originally inclusiveness, diversity, and dynamism is that it originated from the concept of 'To' (Earth) in Yin-Yang and the Five Elements. Daesoon thought reactivated this 'I' concept as the concept of 'To', thereby enabling the introduction of the 'I' concept, compared to Donghak thought which was biased towards the 'Gihwa' (Ki-transformation) concept; consequently, it was able to introduce the accompanying concept of Sinmyeong (spirits/gods) and present a more concrete indigenous modernity.

元亨利貞大經大法道正天地數定千法而理定心法⁸²⁸

In the passage above, which appears in the 'Gakdomun' (Writing on Awakening to the Dao) that defines the awakening of the Dao, this appears between the four virtues of origination-flourishing-benefiting-firmness and the concept of the mind that signifies Earth (To); by expressing that the mind's becoming To is the very concept of fixing the mind being li, it shows that the relationship between li (理) and qi (氣) is the relationship between To and Wood-Fire-Metal-Water. Daesoon Thought indirectly emphasizes that the starting point of Li-Qi theory is yin-yang and the Five Elements, and that it derives from Shao Yong.

Sangje said, "There is a saying that for words, there was Su Qin and Zhang Yi, for knowledge, there was Shao Kangjie, and for writing, there was Li Tai-Bai and Du Zimei. In The Songs of the Eastern Learning, these three energies are embedded. Contemplate this deeply."⁸²⁹

⁸²⁷ Jang Ip-mun et al., trans. *An Yu-gyeong, Ri-ui Cheollhak* (The Philosophy of Li/Principle), Seoul: Yemunseowon, 2004, pp.30-36, 46, 49, 106.

⁸²⁸ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gyoun" (Progress of the Order) 2-33. Wonhyeong ijong, daegyeong daebeop, do jeong cheonji, su jeong cheonbeop, i jeong simbeop. The Way (Do) rectifies Heaven and Earth, Numbers (Su) fix the myriad laws, and Principle (Ri) governs the mind-method. (Choe Chi-bong, "Daesoon Sasang-ui Taegeuk-e Gwanhan Yeongu" [A Study on the Supreme Ultimate in Daesoon Thought], *Daesoon Sasang Nonchong* [Journal of Daesoon Studies] 23, 2014, p.403)

⁸²⁹ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gyobeop" (Teachings) 2-42.

That the starting point of Li-Qi theory was yin-yang and the Five Elements was long forgotten by Neo-Confucianism. Neo-Confucianism's defeat by the West is also located in the very point that it discarded yin-yang and the Five Elements on its own. Yin-yang and the Five Elements were the starting point of Li-Qi theory, but the Neo-Confucians accepted Li-Qi theory while regarding yin-yang and the Five Elements as superstition. After Matteo Ricci, the superstitionizing of yin-yang and the Five Elements accelerated. The re-illumination of the Shao Yong theory by Seo Myeong-eung and others, who grounded yin-yang and the Five Elements in Li-Qi theory, was inevitable at the time.

If the resolution of grievances for mutual beneficence (haewon-sangsaeng) through humanity's harmonizing (jori) is realized, the Eastern and Western divine-human relationships can be integrated with each other. Once it becomes clear that divine beings exist as yin-yang and the Five Elements, the Western earth-water-fire-wind also becomes one part of the circle's circulation. In the West, the concept of divine beings has been demoted to the concept of angels, but the angels too are restored to the status of divine beings.⁸³⁰

The West's ancestral spirits (seollyeongsin) are also restored. In the West too, the ancestral spirits related to humans and the divine beings of Heaven and Earth related to nature are distinguished. When angels become the same as divine beings, in the West too the human becomes a being that merges with angels. By the respective natures of East and West, the West has had an affinity with subterranean deities, but with the union of yin-yang in virtue (eumyang-hapdeok), the West too dwells together with the spirits of ancestors. Daesoon Thought, by saying that 'after an ancestor passes four generations, it becomes both a spirit (yeong) and an immortal (seon),' explains both Li-Qi theory and the theory of the soul. If the concept of angels is converted into divine beings in the West, the character of the Absolute is also converted. In the East, the ultimate being was rendered as a principle, as in the Limitless (Mugeuk) and the Supreme Ultimate (Taegeuk); but, accepting also the Western-religious tradition in which Jesus personified it under the name of Father, Daesoon Thought concretizes the Limitless and the Supreme Ultimate under names such as the God of the Limitless (Mugeuksin), thereby re-establishing the Eastern and Western divine-human relationship. The re-established Eastern and Western divine-human relationship can also explain the changes of nature as follows.⁸³¹

On the next day after Doju came back from Haein-sa Temple (Ocean Seal Temple), he gathered many disciples and said, "Even though Sangje defined the Ocean Seal as a seal, it is wrong for you to take it as a tangible object. The Ocean Seal is not far but close at hand. The origin of the principles of all things in the

⁸³⁰ In today's Western 'thanatology' (death studies), the West also acknowledges the existence of ancestral spirits (Seonlyeongsin). Although it began with the hospice movement aimed at 'well-dying,' modern Western thanatology has verified through tens of thousands of near-death experience cases that, just as in the East, people in the afterlife encounter ancestral spirits whom they had never met while alive. (Eben Alexander; Ptolemy Tompkins [co-authors], trans. Ko Mi-ra; Yi Jin [co-translators], Na-neun Cheonguk-eul Bo-asda [Proof of Heaven], Paju: Gimyeongsa, 2013, pp.124-130, 190)

⁸³¹ Michel Serres regards the concept of angels, like the Eastern concept of Sinmyeong (divine spirits), not as a simple concept but as a decisive occasion for shaping the epistemological framework of the West. (Michel Serres, trans. Yi Gyu-hyeon, Heremes, Seoul: Minumsa, 2009, pp.299-303)

universe lies in the ocean. So, there are sayings of 'the Ocean Seal' and 'a Perfected Being on an ocean island.' Take a look at the sea water. It is all electrified. Water flows down but has the characteristic of ascending. Originally, all things are generated and grow by absorbing the energy of water. There are 36 Heavens in the sky and Sangje governs them. As he presides over electricity, rules, and nurtures all nature in Heaven and Earth, He is, accordingly, Nwehseong Bohwa Cheonjon Sangje [雷聲普化天尊上帝 The Supreme God, the Celestial Worthy of Universal Creation through His Thunderbolt]. Since the electricity of Heaven is in the ocean water, all things are surrounded by electricity.”⁸³²

In Donghak, the concept of 'qi-transformation (gihwa 氣化)' appears in the part 'inwardly there is the divine spirit, outwardly there is qi-transformation (內有神靈 外有氣化).' In the case of 'the divine spirit within and qi-transformation without,' the divine spirit and qi-transformation are another concept by which Donghak connects East and West. Suun expresses the image of the Lord of Heaven (Cheonju)—who is personal yet at the same time impersonal, external yet at the same time fully immanent—as 'there is the divine spirit within us and qi-transformation without (內有神靈 外有氣化).' Looking at the 'Nonhangmun,' one can see that Choe Je-u went a step beyond the general 'Eastern Way, Western implements (Dongdo-Seogi)' theory and highly evaluated Western learning and morality.⁸³³

“Westerners perfect the Dao and establish virtue (道成立德), and as for their creative transformation, there is nothing they cannot accomplish. When they attack with weapons, no one can stand before them in battle; if China is destroyed, how could we be free from the worry of 'lips gone, teeth cold'? There is no other reason for it. They call their Dao the Western Way (西道), their learning the Lord of Heaven (天主) [Learning], and their teaching the Holy Teaching (聖教). Is this not knowing the time of Heaven (天時) and receiving the mandate of Heaven (天命)?”⁸³⁴

On the other hand, Suun criticizes the practice of the Western teaching. In the phrase 'the Western teaching has no numinous spirit of qi-transformation, and its learning has no teaching of the Lord of Heaven,' the latter, 'the learning has no teaching of the Lord of Heaven (學無天主之教),' is said to mean 'the learning has no teaching of the Lord of Heaven's descending word (學無天主降話之教)'—that is, not having inwardly received the teaching of the descending word (降話). Suun's criticism that Westerners do not even know how to serve the Lord of Heaven and ultimately only pray for themselves is because he saw

⁸³² Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gyoun" (Progress of the Order) 2-55.

⁸³³ Baek Min-jeong, "Jeong Yak-yong-gwa Choe Je-u-ui Sayu: Sangje-wa Sim Gaenyeom-euro Bigyo" [A Comparison of the Thought of Jeong Yak-yong and Choe Je-u through the Concepts of Sangje (Lord on High) and Sim (Mind/Heart)], *Minjok Munhwa* (National Culture) 61, 2022, p.149.

⁸³⁴ Donggyeong Daejeon (The Eastern Canon), "Nonhangmun" (On Learning).

that they do not know the numinous spirit of qi-transformation that mediates and makes mutually belong the 'I' and the 'you.'⁸³⁵

Daesoon Thought has revealed, as a point of difference, that it emphasizes the feminine mind rather than the masculine energy (gi) emphasized in Donghak Thought.

In The Songs of Suwun, there is a saying, "If the energy of the Dao is maintained for a long time, wickedness cannot enter [道氣長存邪不入]." However, I say, "If a perfected heart is adamantly guarded, blessings will come first [眞心堅守福先來]."⁸³⁶

That the feminine mind is emphasized in Daesoon Thought, unlike the masculine 'utmost qi (jigi)' emphasized in Donghak Thought, is because the resolution of grievances according to principle (li) is emphasized. 'Understanding (ihae),' the resolution of grievances by principle, is continually emphasized in Daesoon Thought together with 'reconciliation (hwahae).' The reason Donghak Thought is being re-illuminated today is, on the one hand, the aspect of its autogenous character connected to Korea's autogenous modernity; but it is also that Donghak Thought is a thought that contains a critique of materialistic modern civilization and an alternative future vision. Donghak Thought regards materialistic modern civilization as the legacy of Catholic Western Learning (Seohak), and criticizes Western Learning as outwardly advocating equality while, in the course of its practice, betraying Heaven through each-person-for-oneself-mindedness (gakja-wisim).⁸³⁷⁸³⁸

The present status of Donghak Thought, while Donghak Thought itself is meager, still exerts great influence today through the expansion of Donghak-related thought that arose after Donghak. Most Donghak-related thought proposed gaebyeok (the Great Opening) as an alternative. In particular, Donghak aimed at a short-term, external, social gaebyeok. By contrast, Daesoon Thought aimed at a long-term, religious gaebyeok by divine beings.

In that East Asia of the time, at a grim moment when, having fallen to colonial status, the identity of an entire people maintained for 5,000 years was about to be annihilated, Korean new religions—rarely paralleled—presented a rosy vision of the future and won great response from the populace of the time. In fact, that vision, depending on interpretation, has proven accurate up to the present, so that the religious influence of those new religions persists even today.

To the Donghak participants who had become frustrated by the failure of the future vision of becoming kings, marquises, generals, and ministers, Jeungsan presents the True Donghak of grievance-resolution and gaebyeok as the cause of, and remedy for, Donghak's failure.

⁸³⁵ Son Byeong-uk, "Donghak-gwa Bulgyo Yeombulseon-ui Sujeung Chegye Bigyo" [A Comparison of the Cultivation Systems of Donghak and Buddhist Yeombul-Seon], *Donghak Hakbo* (Journal of Donghak Studies) 23, 2011, p.107.

⁸³⁶ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gyobeob" (Teachings) 2-3.

⁸³⁷ The murals of Daesoon Jinrihoe depict Oseon Wigi (Five Immortals Playing Baduk), which represents Haewon Sangsaeng (Resolution of Grievances for Mutual Flourishing), as expressing 'benefit' (Yi/Ihae).

⁸³⁸ Kim Yong-ok, *Donggyeong Daejeon 2* (The Eastern Canon, vol. 2), Tongnamu, 2021, p.135.

One day, Sangje took Gyeong-seok from Nongam and, on the way to Jeongeup, stopped at a tavern in Wonpyeong, called over a passerby, bought him alcohol, and said, "This road is the sea route to Namjoseon (Southern Joseon). We must load much cargo before departing," and then hurried on the road, reaching a place thirty ri away, saying, "A great formation (Daejin) travels thirty ri in one party," and stayed at the house of Park Gong-woo, who lived in the jaesil (ritual house) of the Choe family in Songwol-ri, Gobu. He said to Gong-woo and Gyeong-seok, "Now that I have met the one I was meant to meet, the Tongjeongsin (Spirit of Mutual Understanding) emerges. My work is something that even my parents and siblings do not know." He continued, "I descended to the Cheongyetap (Tower of Divine Revelation) in the Great Western Nation of France, toured the world (Daesoon), and then, taking the authority of the Three Realms (Samgye), I came to open a paradise (Seongyeong) through the Gaebyeok of the Three Realms and save the people of the world who have fallen into annihilation; the reason I stopped in this land while touring your Eastern country is to first help the obscure, weak nation buried in calamity and resolve the grievances accumulated throughout the ages. Those who follow me will receive eternal fortune and blessings, achieve immortality, and enjoy the pleasures of an eternal paradise; this is the True Donghak. In the Gungeul-ga (Song of Gungeul), it is said, 'The lands and rivers of Joseon are a famed land (Myeongsan). A Dotong Gunja (Gentleman who has attained the Dao) will be born again'; this also refers to my work. It is transmitted among Donghak followers that a Daeseonsaeng (Great Teacher) will be reborn (gaengsaeng); this means a Daeseonsaeng (Teacher of the Era) will emerge again, and I am that Daeseonsaeng."

In the passage above, Jeungsan says that the original purpose of Donghak was to help Korea—an obscure, weak nation—and to resolve the age-old grievances accumulated across the whole world and thereby present an earthly paradise; that Donghak failed only because it could not fulfill its original purpose; and that henceforth Donghak's purpose will be realized through the True Donghak. In fact, after Jeungsan, Korea was rather handed over to Japanese rule; yet after Japanese rule, just as Jeungsan envisioned, Korea—then among the world's lowest-ranked nations and a country that had experienced colonization—became a political, economic, and cultural advanced nation in what is called the Miracle on the Han River. Daesoon Thought, by emphasizing the 'virtue of Earth (jideok 地德)' over against the anxious future brought about by Donghak Thought's 'qi-transformation (gihwa 氣化),' made a life of peace of mind and peace of body (ansim-ansin) possible.

Noiemugang (勞而無功) and Cheonji Seonggong (天地成功)

In the view of Earth (Jigwan) of Donghak thought and Daesoon thought, the terms that clearly reveal the difference between them are No-i-mugong (Labor without Achievement) and Cheonji-seonggong (Success of Heaven and Earth). 'No-i-mugong,' meaning 'labored but achieved no success,' is the term used in Donghak thought—where the Cheonoecheon (Heaven beyond Heaven) appeared only as a spirit

(Sinmyeong)—to describe its own achievements, while Cheonji-seonggong is the term Guchon (Ninth Heaven) used to describe Heaven and Earth after the incarnation into a human body.

In traditional Yin-Yang and Five Elements, the term contrasted with Cheonji-seonggong (Success of Heaven and Earth) is Cheonji-hwayuk (Transformation and Nurturance by Heaven and Earth). In the ideal Samjae (Three Powers) concept, such as Cheonwon-jibang (Heaven is round, Earth is square) and Cheondo-jideok (Heaven's Dao, Earth's Virtue), Heaven and Earth nurture humans (hwayuk) to achieve the success of Heaven and Earth, much like parents raising children for the success of the family. No-i-mugong means that there were no instances of success. Although there are many terms for Heaven and Earth in Eastern thought, such as 'Cheonwon-jibang,' Donghak thought is unique in providing the first clue to the concept of Cheonji-seonggong (Success of Heaven and Earth). In Donghak thought, Cheonji-seonggong appears in the expression of Cheonju (Lord of Heaven) as "No-i-mugong" (Labor without Achievement). The No-i-mugong of Donghak thought becomes the gateway to understanding the Cheonji-seonggong of Daesoon thought. Cheonji-seonggong is the Earthly Paradise (Jisang-cheonguk) where Earth and Heaven achieve Yin-Yang virtuous concordance (Eumyang-hapdeok), and it becomes the success of Cheonju (the Lord of Heaven).⁸³⁹

Since No-i-mugong appears in Donghak thought in the scene of realizing that Cheonji (Heaven and Earth) is Cheonju (the Lord of Heaven), i.e., Gwishin (spirit/god), it is necessary to understand the existing Eastern concept of Gwishin to understand No-i-mugong. In Donghak thought, Gwishin means the Cheonoecheon (Heaven beyond Heaven), but understanding why the Cheonoecheon was expressed using the term Gwishin requires an understanding of the traditional concept of Gwishin.

Zhu Xi (Juja) says, "Matters related to Gwishin (spirits) are inherently of secondary importance; Gwishin, having no form or shadow, are difficult to understand, so there is no need to forcibly try to understand them; one should first approach the urgent necessities of daily life and study those." The discourse on Gwishin (Gwishin-ron) is not a discourse at the level of the Sohak (Small Learning), where one learns 'Sa' (affairs/practice) with the body, but a discourse at the level of the Daehak (Great Learning), where one investigates 'I' (principle) with the mind.⁸⁴⁰ Song-Ming Neo-Confucianism (Songmyeong-ihak) is broadly divided into the Zhu Xi school (Jujahak) and the Wang Yangming school (Yangmyeonghak), and the two are sometimes seen as contradictory; however, in reality, although they differ in terms of their methodology of 'study' (Gongbu-ron), they do not differ in terms of their 'ontology' (Bonche-ron). Ontologically speaking, the 'substance (Che) of I (Principle)' becomes Mu (Nothingness/Non-being) and Heo (Void/Emptiness).⁸⁴¹

⁸³⁹ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gyoun" (Progress of the Order) 1-66.

⁸⁴⁰ 『朱子語類』 卷3, 中華書局, 33 夸."鬼神事自是第二著.那箇無形影底,是難理會底.末消去理會,且就日用緊切處做工夫".

⁸⁴¹ Choe Jin-deok, "The I-Gi Theory and Gwishin Theory of Zhu Xi Studies (朱子學의 理氣論과 鬼神論)," Yangmyeonghak (Journal of Wang Yangming Studies), vol. 23, Korean Society of Wang Yangming Studies, 2009, pp.381-382.

In the end, the view of the earthly realm in Daesoon Thought appears as the importance of 'To' (Earth element), which signifies the center of yin-yang and the Five Elements. 'Toiling without merit (no-i-mugong)' and 'the success of Heaven and Earth (cheonji-seonggong)' are two different theories expressing the role of Gucheon as To. The period before the human incarnation and descent is expressed as 'toiling without merit,' and the period after as 'the success of Heaven and Earth.'⁸⁴²

Consequently, the Donghak view of Earth (Jigwan) is also understood as a form that emphasizes the life-thought (Saengmyeong-sasang) of the earth. As Donghak is re-examined as a life-thought, Donghak's emphasis on the earth is also being re-examined. It is said that today's organic farming methods in Korea also originated from the earth-centric thought of Donghak. However, in Donghak thought itself, the importance of the earth, equal to that of heaven, is not actually emphasized. Here, Donghak refers only to early Donghak, following the Jeon-gyeong (Daesoon Scriptures) of Daesoon thought, so only early Donghak will be considered. What is mainly referred to as Donghak in the Jeon-gyeong are the Donghak Gasa (Donghak Songs/Lyrics) and Su-un Gasa (Su-un's Songs/Lyrics).

Cheonji-seonggong (Success of Heaven and Earth) is a concept meaning that Heaven and Earth divide roles to accomplish the work, and it is a term that appears in Daesoon thought, which, unlike Donghak thought, emphasizes Sinmyeong (spirits/gods). Even in the traditional East Asian view of Earth (Jigwan), the earth, as in the term 'Cheonji' (Heaven-and-Earth), superficially appears as equal to heaven. Representatively, Cheonwon-jibang (Heaven is round, Earth is square) does not refer to the erroneous claim of geocentrism (Cheondongseol) revealed by heliocentrism (Jidongseol) that the sky is round, but rather it is an abbreviation for "Cheondo-jiwi-won Jido-jiwi-bang" (The Dao of Heaven is called Round, the Dao of Earth is called Square), and it can be said to refer to the one-dimensional character of "Ju" (宙), representing time, and the two-dimensional character of "U" (宇), representing space. The heaven of the I Ching (Juyeok) is called "Geon" (乾), and this "Geon" (meaning 'dry') signifies the dry attribute of time, which performs the function of "Sae Eul" (乙, the second heavenly stem, often associated with budding/new growth).

Daesoon thought reifies the traditional view of Earth (Jigwan) through the Cheonji-gongsa (Reordering Works of Heaven and Earth), which changes Eogeum-jonyang (Suppressing Yin and Venerating Yang) to Jeong-eum-jeong-yang (Correct Yin and Correct Yang). Consequently, the earth is also realigned, just like the heavens (Cheonmun, astronomy/celestial patterns). Daesoon thought starts from the Samshinsan (Three Divine Mountains), the Bumo-san (Parent Mountains) of Hoemun-san and Moak-san are put in order, and the Hyeoljari (Acupoints/Vital Spots) of the San-wang (Mountain King) and Hae-wang (Sea King) are aligned.⁸⁴³ Jisang-cheonguk (Earthly Paradise), the result of the Yin-Yang virtuous

⁸⁴² Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Haengrok" (Acts) 2-16.

⁸⁴³ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Haengrok" (Acts) 1-2.

concordance (Eumyang-hapdeok) of Heaven and Earth, is the term representing the Daesoon view of the Earthly Realm (Jigyegwan), where the Three Realms (Samgye) act correlatively.⁸⁴⁴

The fact that the Donghak Ji-In (Earth-Human) relationship of Bulyeongiyeon (Not-so, yet-so), after being conceived (Potae), is nurtured (Yangsaeng) is largely due to the revitalization of Daesoon thought's Jigye-gongsa (Reordering Work of the Earthly Realm), which reassigned the Samshinsan and the Bumosan. In Daesoon thought, the Samgye-chakran (Disorder of the Three Realms) manifests in the Ji-In (Earth-Human) relationship as world wars due to Jigi-bultong (non-communication of Earth's Ki/energy) and human arrogance stemming from material civilization. The disharmony of Jigi (Earth's Ki), identified in Daesoon thought as the cause of world disputes, is unified through the Jigi-tongil-gongsa (Reordering Work for the Unification of Earth's Ki). After Matteo Ricci opened the exchange between Eastern and Western Sinmyeong (spirits/gods), modern civilization was pioneered through the exchange between the Jihamunmyeong-sin (Underground Civilization Spirits) and the Cheonsang (Heavenly Realm) and their bestowal of grace upon the Inse (Human World). However, modern civilization, due to human arrogance and an imbalance toward material civilization, resulted in the crisis of 'Cheonha-jinmyeol' (Annihilation of the World). Therefore, Daesoon thought seeks to construct the Ji-In (Earth-Human) relationship of the Jisang-sinseon (Earthly Immortal) as a Dosul-munmyeong (Civilization of Daoist Magic/Arts) over material civilization, through the Jigye-gongsa (Reordering Work of the Earthly Realm).⁸⁴⁵

Choe Su-un perceived Japan as the enemy (Wonsu) that invaded our country during the Imjin War (Japanese invasions of Korea in 1592-1598) and, therefore, as an object of revenge that must be destroyed.⁸⁴⁶ On the other hand, Jeungsan (Gang Il-sun) saw that Japan, contrarily, had formed grievances (Won) during the Imjin War because they failed to enter Seoul, many innocent lives were killed, and furthermore, they taught Joseon the method of rice planting; therefore, to resolve this, he conducted a Gongsa (Reordering Work) entrusting Joseon to Japan.⁸⁴⁷ Furthermore, Jeungsan said not to oppose Japan but to be obedient, and prophesied that Japan would be defeated in the future and return [home] empty-handed, without even receiving wages for their work.⁸⁴⁸ Many existing studies also interpret Jeungsan's Gongsa of temporarily entrusting Joseon to Japan in order to protect the Joseon people from Western

⁸⁴⁴ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gongsa" (Reordering Works) 3-6.

⁸⁴⁵ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gyoun" (Progress of the Order) 1-9.

⁸⁴⁶ Choe Su-un took pride in the fact that his seventh-generation ancestor Jin-rip (震立) rendered great service and died in battle during the Imjin War and the Byeongjahoran, and was posthumously awarded the office of Byeongjopanseo (Minister of War) and the posthumous title of Jeongmugong. In the Ansimga (Song of Solace), through expressions such as "those dog-like Japanese enemies (倭敵)" and "they too are enemies," he framed Japan in an adversarial relationship. (Bak Gwang-su, Hanguk sinjonggyo-ui sasang-gwa jonggyo munhwa (Thought and Religious Culture of Korean New Religions), Seoul: Jipmundang, 2012, pp.199-201).

⁸⁴⁷ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Yeosi" (Prophetic Elucidations) 74.

⁸⁴⁸ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Yeosi" (Prophetic Elucidations) 57.

powers as showing that Jeungsan temporarily utilized Imperial Japan's theory of hegemony in East Asia.⁸⁴⁹

Comparison of Autogenous Modernity in Views of Humanity

Innaechoen (人乃天) and Sinin Johwa (神人調化)

"Innaechoen" (人乃天, Man is Heaven), meaning "Man is Heaven," is not an expression used by Su-un in early Donghak; however, it is evaluated as a concept that conforms to Western modernity by excluding the transcendent aspects and maximizing the immanent aspects of the Cheon-In (Heaven-Human) and Ji-In (Earth-Human) relationships in Donghak thought, which are characterized by Naeyu-sinryeong (Indwelling Spirit) and Oeyu-gihwa (Externalized Ki-transformation). In Cheondogyo (Religion of the Heavenly Way), which interpreted Su-un's thought after the rise of Cheondogyo, "Innaechoen" is used as the phrase representing the modernity of Donghak thought. The reason "Innaechoen" was designated as the term representing the modernity of Donghak thought was because of the egalitarian ideology it implies. "Innaechoen"—the idea that even the Baekjeong (the lowest caste), women, and children could become Heaven—was a very advanced ideology for a pre-modern society where only the "Cheonja" (Son of Heaven/Emperor) could be Heaven, as it asserted equality in the human world, excluding the world of spirits (Sinmyeonggye).⁸⁵¹

Daesoon thought saw "Haewon" (Resolution of Grievances) as the reason Donghak thought failed, despite the "Innaechoen" ideology receiving much support. In Daesoon thought, egalitarianism was not something that came instantaneously, like a revolution, but was a gradual process that came through Haewon and the resulting Sangsaeng (Mutual Beneficence).

Furthermore, Daesoon thought does not express that "Man is Heaven." In Daesoon thought, Heaven (Haneul) means not only the existing heaven divided from earth (Cheonji), but also Heaven as the Guchon (Ninth Heaven) that presides over all things in the universe (Samra-mansang). In Daesoon thought, which emphasizes the grace of Heaven, humans cannot become beings equal to Heaven. However, in Daesoon thought, where the incarnation into a human body occurred, human status is elevated in a different way than in Donghak thought. The thought of Su-un in early Donghak was also "Osim-jeuk-Yeosim" (My heart is precisely your heart), not "Innaechoen." Daesoon thought, on the contrary, points to humanity and modernity—which have forgotten the grace of Heaven and Earth (Cheonji)—as the cause of the problems, and insists on respecting Heaven and Earth.

⁸⁴⁹ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gongsa" (Reordering Works) 2-4.

⁸⁵⁰ Kang Don-ku, *Hanguk geundae jonggyo-wa minjokjuui* (Korean Modern Religion and Nationalism), Seoul: Jipmundang, 1992.; Bak Jae-hyeon, "The Characteristics of Daesoon Thought in the Modern Period of Korea: Focused on Transnationalism and Modern and Post-modern Values," *Daesoon Sasang Nonchong* (Journal of Daesoon Thought) 24, 2014.

⁸⁵¹ Hwang Jong-won, "A Critical Study on the Innaechoen Doctrine and the Theory of Mind-Nature in Cheondogyo in the Early 20th Century," *Daedong Cheolhak* (Journal of Daedong Philosophy) 44, 2008, pp.92-93.

事之當旺在於天地 必不在人

然無人無天地 故天地生人 用人

以人生 不參於天地用人之時 何可曰人生乎⁸⁵²

The example above clarifies that the beginning and end of affairs reside in Heaven and Earth, not in Man. Ultimately, Daesoon thought shows that in order to achieve the egalitarian world that Innaechoen aims for, Boeun (Grateful Reciprocation of Favors) to Heaven and Earth and the Haewon (Resolution of Grievances) of humanity for that purpose must take precedence, and that Haewon, not revolution (Byeonhyeok), is the true modernity.⁸⁵³

Therefore, what Daesoon thought presents in response to Innaechoen (which aims for revolution) is the harmony of spirits/gods (Sin) and humans (In), namely, Sin-in-johwa (Harmonious Union between Divine Beings and Human Beings). Here, Johwa (調化, Harmonious Transformation/Union) is a compound word formed by combining 'Jo' (調) from Johwa (調和, Harmony/Accord) and 'Hwa' (化) from Johwa (造化, Creation/Transformation); it is a word that does not exist in conventional dictionaries and appears only in Daesoon thought. Johwa (調化) can be said to be a combination that gathers only the advantages of Johwa (調和, Harmony) and Johwa (造化, Creation).⁸⁵⁴

The relationship between Sinmyeong (spirits/gods) and humans in Daesoon thought, which does not appear in Donghak thought, is the core point of difference in the indigenous modernity of the human view (Ingwan) between Donghak thought and Daesoon thought. Donghak thought saw the cause of the problem of modernity as a human problem, namely 'Gakja-wisim' (Each acting for oneself), but in Daesoon thought, the cause of the problem of modernity is human foolishness in not knowing the grace of the Cheonjisinmyeong (Spirits of Heaven and Earth). The perspective of Daesoon thought reflects the perspective of the Guchon (Ninth Heaven). In Daesoon thought, thinking of humans as beings equal to Heaven, like in Innaechoen, is human arrogance and foolishness. If humans do not know the grace of Heaven and Earth or act contrary to Heaven and Earth, no work can succeed. Therefore, Daesoon thought regards Emperor Yao, who made humans aware of the grace of Heaven and Earth, as a very exemplary model of humanity.⁸⁵⁵

⁸⁵² Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gyobeob" (Teachings) 3-47. Saji-dangwang-jae-eo-cheonji, pil-bu-jae-in, yeon-mu-in-mu-cheonji, go-cheonji-saeng-in-yong-in, i-insaeng-bulcham-eo-cheonji, yong-in-ji-si-ha-ga-wal-insaeng-ho. The fundamental cause of any affair being accomplished lies in Heaven and Earth, not necessarily in human beings. However, since Heaven and Earth are useless without human beings, Heaven and Earth produce human beings and employ them. This being the case, if, when Heaven and Earth wish to employ human beings, a person does not follow the will of Heaven and Earth, how can this be called a human life? (Gyomubu, "Cheonji Saeng-in Yong-in" (Heaven and Earth Produce and Employ Human Beings), Daesoon Hoebo (Daesoon Circular) 13, 1989)

⁸⁵³ Yi Gyeong-won, "The Modernity of Daesoon Truth and the Thought of Transformation," Donghak Hakbo (Journal of Donghak Studies) 9(2): 43, 2005.

⁸⁵⁴ Yi Gyeong-won, Daesoon Jonghak Wonron (Principles of Daesoon Religious Studies), Seoul: Munsacheol, 2013.

⁸⁵⁵ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gyoun" (Progress of the Order) 1-66.

On the 23rd day of the twelfth lunar month of the Jeongmi year, Sangje visited Shin Gyeong-su at his house. Sangje spoke about Yao's "observing the sun, moon, and stars, and respectfully bestowing the seasons upon the people" (yeoksang ilwolsesungsin gyeongsuinsi), saying, "Heaven and Earth, without the sun and moon, are an empty shell; the sun and moon, without a person of wisdom (ji-in), are an empty shadow. Because Dang Yao (Emperor Yao) discerned the laws of the sun and moon and taught them to the people, the grace of Heaven and the principles of Earth were finally bestowed upon humanity." At this time, Sangje taught, "The sun and moon govern all things without selfishness; the rivers and mountains have the Dao and receive hundreds of practices (日月無私治萬物 江山有道受百行)," and He composed the Five Mantras (Oju), calling them the "Essence (Jinaek) of Heaven and Earth," and the Five Mantras are as follows.

新天地家家長歲 日月日月萬事知

侍天主造化定永世不忘萬事知

福祿誠敬信 壽命誠敬信 至氣今至願爲大降

明德觀音八陰八陽 至氣今至願爲大降

三界解魔大帝神位願趁天尊關聖帝君⁸⁵⁶

In the example above, it is said that Emperor Yao's greatest contribution lies in conveying "the grace of Heaven and the principles of Earth" to humankind, that is, in making humans aware of the grace of Heaven and Earth. In contrast to Innaechoen, Daesoon thought instead presents the harmony of spirits/gods and humans, namely Sin-in-uido (Mutual guidance and reliance between Divine Beings and Human Beings), as humanity's greatest task.⁸⁵⁷

In Donghak thought, Cheonju (Lord of Heaven) and Sangje (Supreme Ruler) are mentioned, but expressions regarding Sinmyeong (spirits/gods) or Sindo (Dao of spirits/gods) hardly appear. This also applies to the Samjae (Three Powers), and the expression 'Samgye' (Three Realms), which presupposes the Sinmyeonggye (World of Spirits/Gods), also hardly appears in Donghak thought. Daesoon thought transcends the limits of the Indo (Human Dao) presented by Donghak thought, by means of the Sindo (Dao of spirits/gods) which Donghak thought could not accept due to the limitations of Confucianism (Yugyo-ui Jeonheon).

Daesoon thought brings the expression 'Samgye' (Three Realms) to the forefront in response to human arrogance, such as Innaechoen. Humans do not become equal to Heaven; rather, the Guchon (Ninth Heaven) changes the old heaven into a new heaven. Even among the denominations that venerate Gang Il-sun (Jeungsan), Daesoon thought is an ideology that particularly brings the Samgye (Three Realms) to the

⁸⁵⁶ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gyoun" (Progress of the Order) 1-30.

⁸⁵⁷ Daesoon Jinrihoe Yeolam (Daesoon Jinrihoe Overview), "Chwiji" (Purpose/Mission).

forefront, in that the term 'Daesoon' (Great Itineration) is an abbreviation for "Samgye-Daesoon Gaebyeok-Gongsa" (The Reordering Work of the Great Opening of the Three Realms through Great Itineration).

If Daesoon thought is explained centering on the Three Realms (Samgye), it is a series of processes: the Three Realms, harmonized by Sangje, fall into disorder (Samgye-chakran) due to human grievances (Wonhan); furthermore, as they reach the state of 'Samgye-jinmyeol' (Annihilation of the Three Realms), Sangje, upon the appeal of the Sinseong (Divine Sages), Bul (Buddhas), and Bosal (Bodhisattvas), diagnoses the Three Realms through the Samgye-Daesoon (Great Itineration of the Three Realms) and then achieves the Samgye-Gaebyeok (Great Opening of the Three Realms) through the Samgye-gongsa (Reordering Work of the Three Realms); this is the Samgye-Daesoon, and the ideology accompanying it is Daesoon thought.

The Three Realms of Daesoon Jinrihoe, which are operated by Sinmyeong (spirits/gods), are operated by countless Sinmyeong. In Daesoon thought, the reason the Three Realms are operated by Sinmyeong is that Sinmyeong are beings who are "perfect" (or "extreme") in truth (Jinri-e Jigeukhan).

One day in the first month of the Jeongmi year, while Kim Gwang-chan and Shin Won-il were attending Sangje, Sangje said to them, "Spiritual beings (gwisin) are utmost in truth (jilli), so I judge the Cheonjigongsa (Work of Reordering Heaven and Earth) together with them," and posted a writing on the wall as follows.⁸⁵⁸

In the example above, "being perfect in truth" means being faithful to the roles and boundaries of the Sinmyeong. Unlike humans, who possess both Hon (spirit-soul) and Baek (body-soul) and thus have diversity but cannot be faithful to only one role, in Daesoon thought, Sinmyeong are beings possessing only one of Hon or Baek; therefore, they can be faithful to one role and can operate Heaven and Earth (Cheonji). Therefore, in Daesoon Thought, the harmony between Sinmyeong (divine beings) who operate the Three Realms and human beings becomes the core of the new operation of Heaven and Earth.

In Daesoon Thought, the Three Realms are not only related to the operation of Heaven and Earth but also have a close relationship with modern science and technology. In the Daesoon view of the Three Realms, the Heavenly Realm includes the Celestial Realm and the Spirit Realm (Myeongbu), and the Earthly Realm includes the Subterranean Realm; among these, the Celestial and Subterranean Realms are the origin of modern scientific civilization, and the Spirit Realm is where human beings' gratitude (Boeun) for the Sincerity, Reverence, and Faith (Seong, Gyeong, Sin) of Heaven and Earth is evaluated.

One day, Sangje said to Kim Hyeong-ryeol, "The Westerner Matteo Ricci (Yi Madu) came to the East and tried to establish an earthly paradise, but he could not achieve his goal because the deep-rooted evil customs of Confucianism made reform difficult. However, he opened the boundaries between the Celestial and Subterranean Realms, allowing the divine beings (Sinmyeong), who had firmly guarded their respective regions and could not cross over, to interact, and after his death, he took the civilization divine

⁸⁵⁸ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gyoun" (Progress of the Order) 1-19.

beings (Munmyeongsin) of the East to the West and opened the way for cultural development (Mun-un). From this, the Subterranean divine beings (Jihasin) emulated all the wondrous methods of the Celestial Realm and bestowed them upon the human world. All the cultures and materials of the West are modeled after the Kingdom of Heaven," He said.⁸⁵⁹

This excerpt first shows the Sin-in-johwa (Harmonious Union between Divine Beings and Human Beings) of Daesoon Thought, where the interaction between the celestial divine beings and the subterranean divine beings operates Heaven and Earth and also changes the Human Realm. Second, it shows that in Daesoon Thought, the Heavenly Realm includes the Celestial Realm where the celestial divine beings reside, and the Earthly Realm includes the subterranean divine beings (Jihasin). Third, it shows the interaction of the Three Realms, indicating that the exchange between celestial and subterranean divine beings is closely related to the Human Realm, and that the boundary between the Celestial and Subterranean Realms can be changed by figures who existed in the Human Realm.

Sangje said, "In the Seoncheon (Former World), all human affairs and things were governed by Sangguk (mutual conflict/overcoming), causing grievances to accumulate and form knots, filling the Three Realms; thus, Heaven and Earth lost their constant way (Sangdo), giving rise to all sorts of disasters, and the world became tragic." "Therefore, I intend to rectify the Dosu of Heaven and Earth, harmonize the divine beings (Sinmyeong), resolve the grievances of all time, and establish the Seon'gyeong (Immortal Realm) of the Hucheon (Later World) through the Dao of Sangsaeng (mutual beneficence), thereby saving the people of the world." "In all matters, great or small, the grievances must be resolved starting from the Sindo (Dao of Gods/Divine Beings)." "First, if the Dosu is firmly established and harmonized, that will become the foundation, and human affairs (Insa) will be accomplished spontaneously." "This is precisely the Samgye-gongsa (Work of the Three Realms)," He said to Kim Hyeong-ryeol, and He began a part of it, the Myeongbu-gongsa (Work of the Realm of Judgment).⁸⁶⁰

This excerpt first shows that Heaven, Earth, and human beings mutually grow and foster each other's growth. Second, it shows that the Spirit Realm (Myeongbu) is where the divine beings of Heaven and Earth evaluate human beings. However, it shows that this mutual growth was not properly evaluated due to human affairs and material objects dominated by mutual conflict, leading only to increased grievances, which became the cause of the confusion in the Three Realms. Third, the excerpt shows that the Spirit Realm belongs to the Heavenly Realm and is the place where the affairs of the Three Realms are synthesized.

The Daesoon view of the Three Realms, where even human destiny in the Spirit Realm and scientific technology, beyond the operation of the universe, are determined by the divine beings of Heaven and Earth,

⁸⁵⁹ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gyoun" (Progress of the Order) 1-9.

⁸⁶⁰ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gongsa" (Reordering Works) 1-3.

suggests that Heaven and Earth take precedence in human affairs, extending to the determination of all matters.

事之當旺在於天地 必不在人⁸⁶¹,

萬事分已定 浮生空自忙⁸⁶²

Among these two verses, the first verse clearly shows that in the Daesoon view of the Three Realms, Heaven and Earth have priority over human beings in the order of affairs. It shows that the relationship between Heaven and Earth and human beings is similar, just as parents take precedence because even if a child becomes more outstanding than the parents, it is due to the parents' grace. Furthermore, the second verse shows that even if a human being is more successful than Heaven and Earth, this is already predetermined by Heaven and Earth.

The Daesoon view of the Human Realm, as examined through the discussions so far, is as follows. First, the Daesoon view of the Three Realms consists of Sangje of Gucheon (the Highest Heaven) as the supreme God, and the Three Realms of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity, which are harmonized by Sangje. In the Daesoon view of the Three Realms, Heaven and Earth cultivate and nurture all things on behalf of Sangje, while Sangje observes and oversees all heavens (Gwangam-mancheon). Gwangam-mancheon (observing and overseeing all heavens), which means observation, shares similarities with the concept of a hidden god, but it differs in that it specifically involves the medium of Heaven and Earth.⁸⁶³

Heaven and Earth also entrust tasks to countless divine beings, each responsible for specific parts, when cultivating and nurturing the myriad things of the universe. Heaven and Earth meet through ascent and descent; since Heaven and Earth are Yin and Yang, Heaven plans and Earth implements. Therefore, as shown in Geonjeong-Gonsun (Heaven determines and Earth follows), the celestial civilization plans, and the subterranean divine beings emulate and bestow it upon the human world.⁸⁶⁴ Heaven and Earth cultivate and nurture human beings with utmost Sincerity, Reverence, and Faith (Seong, Gyeong, Sin), devoted to truth.⁸⁶⁵ Human beings, who receive life, longevity, and blessings through the cultivation and nurturing of Heaven and Earth with utmost Sincerity, Reverence, and Faith, have an obligation to reciprocate (Boeun) with Sincerity, Reverence, and Faith, just like Heaven and Earth.⁸⁶⁶ However, human beings, having become capable of contending with Heaven and Earth through modern science, betray Heaven and Earth,

⁸⁶¹ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gyobeob" (Teachings) 3-47. Saji-dangwang-jae-eo-cheonji, pil-bu-jae-in: The fundamental cause of any affair being accomplished lies in Heaven and Earth, not necessarily in human beings. (Gyomubu, "Cheonji Saeng-in Yong-in" (Heaven and Earth Produce and Employ Human Beings), Daesoon Hoebo (Daesoon Circular) 13, 1989)

⁸⁶² Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gyobeob" (Teachings) 3-47. Mansa-bun-i-jeong, busaeng-gong-ja-mang: All affairs have their allotted portions already determined, yet the people of the world busily stir about to no avail. (Gyomubu, "Mansa Bun-i-jeong" (All Affairs Have Their Portions Already Determined), Daesoon Hoebo (Daesoon Circular) 148, 2013)

⁸⁶³ Daesoon Jinrihoe Yeolam (Daesoon Jinrihoe Overview), p.7.

⁸⁶⁴ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gyoun" (Progress of the Order) 2-42.

⁸⁶⁵ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gyoun" (Progress of the Order) 1-9.

⁸⁶⁶ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gyoun" (Progress of the Order) 1-9.

deny the existence of the divine beings (Sinmyeong) of Heaven and Earth, and exploit and conquer Heaven and Earth.⁸⁶⁷ Consequently, an era of confusion in the Three Realms ensues, where Heaven and Earth also seek only to kill human beings, leading Sangje to inspect the human world (Daesun) in response to the appeals of divine saints, Buddhas, and Bodhisattvas, first bestowing the Heavenly Mandate (Cheonmyeong) and Divine Teaching (Singyo) upon Su-un, resulting in the emergence of Donghak Thought.⁸⁶⁸ Although Su-un received the Heavenly Mandate and Divine Teaching, he could not overcome the limitations of Confucianism, leading Sangje to directly descend into the human world in human form through the Three Realms; this becomes the background for the Daesoon view of the Human Realm, characterized by the incarnation of Gucheon (Sangje).⁸⁶⁹⁸⁷⁰⁸⁷¹⁸⁷²⁸⁷³

Although it is clearly revealed in Daesoon Thought that the existence and roles of the Three Realms, filled with divine beings, are based on Yin-Yang and the Five Elements, both the East and the West have, since antiquity, posited a Heavenly Realm and an Earthly Realm filled with divine beings that intervene in the Human Realm, much like in Daesoon Thought. The Daesoon view of the Three Realms actually shares many common elements with pre-modern Eastern and Western cosmologies. Therefore, since the Daesoon view of the Three Realms also includes Heaven, Earth, Humanity, and the Spirit Realm (Sinmyeong-gye), notions of the Heavenly, Earthly, and Human Realms from all times and places can also be collectively referred to as the Three Realms and compared. The Daesoon view of the Three Realms is close to a revitalized cosmology that integrates ancient Eastern and Western cosmologies—discarded by modernity—with modern science.

If the Daesoon view of humanity described above is expressed concisely, it can be called a view of humanity based on Sin-in-uido (Mutual Guidance between Divine Beings and Human Beings). If Donghak Thought achieved a liminality from the Western ontological view of the Three Realms to a generative (process-oriented) view of the Three Realms, Daesoon Thought revitalized the relationship between divine beings and human beings inherent in the generative view of the Three Realms through Sin-in-uido.

Buryeon-giyeon (Not so, yet so) and Seongsa-jaein (Accomplishment of affairs lies with human beings)

The conclusive difference between the Donghak and Daesoon views of humanity is Seongsa-jaein (Accomplishment of affairs lies with human beings). Seongsa-jaein in Daesoon Thought means that the determination of an affair's success, which previously rested with Heaven, is now shifted to human beings.

⁸⁶⁷ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gyoun" (Progress of the Order) 1-66.

⁸⁶⁸ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gyoun" (Progress of the Order) 1-19.

⁸⁶⁹ Daesoon Jinrihoe Yeolam (Daesoon Jinrihoe Overview), p.20.

⁸⁷⁰ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gongsa" (Reordering Works) 1-11.

⁸⁷¹ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gyoun" (Progress of the Order) 1-9.

⁸⁷² Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gyoun" (Progress of the Order) 1-9.

⁸⁷³ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Haengrok" (Acts) 1-10.

The difference between the emergence of the Cheon-oe-cheon (Heaven beyond Heaven) in Donghak Thought and the incarnation of Gucheon (Sangje) in Daesoon Thought ultimately manifests as Seongsa-jaein.

A fight among humans causes a fight among the Seonryeongsin (ancestral spirits) in the heavens; only after the heavenly fight ends is the human fight decided.⁸⁷⁴

In the excerpt above, the expression "only after the heavenly fight ends is the human fight decided" signifies Seongsa-jaecheon (Accomplishment of affairs lies with Heaven) of the Former World. In Donghak Thought, which lacks the concept of Sinmyeong, the outcome of a fight is determined by Gi (energy/spirit), whereas in Daesoon Thought, it is the Sinmyeong who determine the fight. In Daesoon Thought, this principle—that divine beings determine human fights—is reversed after Sangje's incarnation, changing the positions of human beings and divine beings.

In the Former World, it was said, "Planning of affairs lies with human beings (Mosa-jaein), and accomplishment of affairs lies with Heaven (Seongsa-jaecheon)," but now, planning of affairs lies with Heaven (Mosa-jaecheon), and accomplishment of affairs lies with human beings (Seongsa-jaein). Furthermore, no matter how much you wish to die, you will not be able to; you can only die when I release you.⁸⁷⁵

In the excerpt above, the expression "now, planning of affairs lies with Heaven (Mosa-jaecheon), and accomplishment of affairs lies with human beings (Seongsa-jaein)" signifies that after the incarnation of Gucheon (Sangje), the locus of decision-making power shifted from divine beings to human beings. The reversal of the positions of planning affairs (Mosa) and accomplishing affairs (Seongsa) after the incarnation is because the ultimate value of human beings was finally revealed through the incarnation of Gucheon (Sangje). This is because the value of human beings as beings who possess both Yin and Yang—body and spirit—was revealed by the incarnation of Gucheon (Sangje). If, before the incarnation, the affairs of the world were accomplished by the divine beings of Heaven and Earth (Cheonji-sinmyeong), the meaning of Seongsa-jaein is that after the incarnation, they are accomplished by human beings.

When Park Gong-u came to Guritgol after arguing with his wife, Sangje suddenly rebuked him, saying, "If I am venomous, I possess all the venom in the world, and if I am good, I possess all the goodness in the world. How can you commit such an unfaithful act while in my presence? Now, the divine beings of Heaven and Earth (Cheonji-sinmyeong) will search for their destined places (Unsu), visiting each person and each household to test their capacity (Giguk). If one's disposition is not generous and harmony is lost in the family, the divine beings will mock them, deeming their capacity unfit for great tasks, and will lead

⁸⁷⁴ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gyobeob" (Teachings) 1-54.

⁸⁷⁵ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gyobeob" (Teachings) 3-35.

each other away; therefore, how can those who aspire to this work dare to be negligent in their thoughts even for a moment?" He said.⁸⁷⁶

In the passage above, the expression 'the divine beings of Heaven and Earth seek out the seat of destiny (unsu)' means that, after the human incarnation and descent of Gucheon, the human being was changed into the seat of destiny that brings affairs to success (seongsa). That the positions of human and divine beings are reversed by the human incarnation and descent of Gucheon is because the divine beings fell into adversity (bigeop 否劫) and humankind fell into calamity (jaegeop 災劫). Comparing the views of humanity in Donghak Thought and Daesoon Thought, Daesoon Thought, through the expansion of correlative thinking, reinforces fractal thinking more than Donghak Thought does. In Daesoon Thought, the human plays the role of yang and the divine beings the role of yin; the harmonious union between divine and human beings (sinin-johwa) is likewise achieved by the principle of the virtuous concordance of yin and yang (eumyang-hapdeok).⁸⁷⁷

Seongsa (accomplishment of affairs) and Mosa (planning of affairs) can be understood through the Yin-Yang and Five Elements as Jori (Regulating Principle) and Gihwa (Materialization/Spiritualization). The relationship between Jori and Gihwa in the Later World is the reverse of that in the Former World. In Donghak Thought, the existence of Earth (To), which regulates Wood, Fire, Metal, and Water, becomes the divine being (Sinmyeong).

In the relationship of Seongsa-jaein, Jori and Gihwa manifest as human regulation (Jori) and divine materialization/spiritualization (Gihwa). This is similar to the relationship between Earth (To) and Wood, Fire, Metal, and Water in the Five Elements. Particularly in Daesoon Thought, human regulation (Jori) and divine materialization/spiritualization (Gihwa) represent a circulation as a principle of Yin-Yang and the Five Elements centered on human beings.

Human regulation (Jori) like Earth (To) and the divine materialization/spiritualization (Gihwa) of Wood, Fire, Metal, and Water have existed in both Eastern and Western traditions. In traditional Eastern thought, existences representing the four cardinal directions, like Wood, Fire, Metal, and Water, have been depicted as divine beings in the form of animals in the Sashindo (Painting of the Four Deities). In the West, too, divine beings have been represented as animals. The Four Elements (Earth, Water, Fire, Air), corresponding to the Western Sashindo, were regarded by Bachelard as the fundamental complex of human imagination.⁸⁷⁸

Gilbert Durand, who succeeded Bachelard, states that the culmination of imagination is when human symbols meet by becoming divine, and human symbols become animals and eventually divine beings.

⁸⁷⁶ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gyobeob" (Teachings) 1-42.

⁸⁷⁷ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Jeosaeng" (Saving Lives) 43.

⁸⁷⁸ Dang Hyeon-seon, *Jilbereou Dyurang-ui Sangsanggye Yeongu* (A Study on Gilbert Durand's Imaginary), Hongik University Graduate School Master's Thesis, 2009, pp.28-30.

Until now, humans have sought to become divine, but in Korea's culture of Simjeong (heart/mind), it is said that divine beings particularly seek to become human.⁸⁷⁹

The I-Gi (Principle and Material Force) theory of the Seoncheon (Former) Yeok (Changes), which Confucius reportedly transmitted to Daoist hermits, differs from the Hucheon (Later) Yeok I-Gi theory of Neo-Confucianism in that Taegeuk (Supreme Ultimate) and Yin-Yang and the Five Elements possess the characteristics of both I and Gi, thus accommodating Confucianism, Buddhism, Daoism, and Western Learning (Seogyo). However, even Shao Kang-jie's I-Gi theory failed to adequately respond to Matteo Ricci's criticisms due to the distortion of the Seoncheon Yin-Yang itself and its lack of explanatory power regarding modern science, leading to the collapse of the Eastern divine-human relationship.⁸⁸⁰

In Daesoon Thought, the liminal property of the view of the Human Realm is also strengthened. Human arrogance and materialism are reflected upon, and the primordial grievance of humanity is resolved (Haewon).⁸⁸¹ Revitalization is expanded through the Dosu of the White-Clad General and the White-Clad Minister, symbolically giving away human flesh and going into exile on Maljeom Island.⁸⁸²⁸⁸³⁸⁸⁴

In the Daesoon view of the Human Realm, the elevation of human status is expressed more clearly than in Donghak. Donghak Thought, which failed to introduce the Spirit Realm (Sinmyeong-gye), expresses the harmonious union between divine beings and human beings as 'Buryeon-giyeon' (Not so, yet so). 'Buryeon-giyeon' means that even the parts that are Buryeon (not so), which are difficult for humans to understand, will one day become Giyeon (so), understandable through spiritual cultivation (Sudo). In Daesoon Thought, many parts that were Buryeon (not so) in Donghak manifest as Giyeon (so). Human beings are divine beings trapped within a body, so by awakening the divine being within, they can communicate with the divine beings outside. The purpose of human birth is to change and develop into a new divine being (Sinmyeong) through the body. One must find the divine being within to find one's lost self and walk the path of a human being who brings success to Heaven and Earth. Therefore, in Daesoon Thought, Gaebyeok (the Great Opening) is the success of Heaven and Earth, which is the world of Dotong-

⁸⁷⁹ Bak Jeong-jin, (Yesul Illyu Hakseoseol) Hanguk Munhwa Simjeong Munhwa ((Introduction to Art Anthropology) Korean Culture: The Culture of Simjeong), Mirae Munhwasa, 1990, pp.130-146.

⁸⁸⁰ The Yin-Yang and Five Elements theory has both positive and negative aspects; in the case of Western scholars, they evaluate Yin-Yang and the Five Elements as objectively as possible, at least appraising it as a primitive form of science. Representative figures include Marcel Granet, Angus Graham, Benjamin Schwartz, and Joseph Needham. (Kim Ki, "A Study on the Application Pattern of the Yin-Yang and Five Elements Theory in Zhu Xi Studies," Sungkyunkwan University Doctoral Dissertation, 2012, p.4) On the other hand, Eastern scholars tend to regard Yin-Yang and the Five Elements as even more superstitious. (Bang In, "Yin-Yang and Five Elements Theory as a Form of Ancient Chinese Cosmology" (고대 중국의 宇宙論의 한 형태로서의 陰陽五行說), Jonggyo Yeongu (Journal of Religious Studies) 4, 1988, p.71)

⁸⁸¹ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gyoun" (Progress of the Order) 1-9.

⁸⁸² Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gongsa" (Reordering Works) 3-14.

⁸⁸³ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gongsa" (Reordering Works) 2-1.

⁸⁸⁴ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Haengrok" (Acts) 3-53.

jingyeong (Perfected State of Unification with the Dao) of Injon (Humanity as the center), possible only after the emergence of Dotong-gunja (Virtuous Scholars Who Have Attained the Dao).⁸⁸⁵

In Daesoon Thought, Sin-in-johwa (Harmonious Union between Divine Beings and Human Beings) becomes the principle of Gaebyeok (the Great Opening) by which Heaven and Earth succeed through human beings. Daesoon Thought explains the reason why Sin-in-johwa is possible through the principles of Yin-Yang and the Five Elements, namely Geumhwa-gyoyeok (Mutual Exchange of Metal and Fire) and Togeuksu (Earth overcomes Water). As seen in the terms "divine beings fallen into Bigeop (calamity of obstruction)" and "human beings fallen into Jaegop (calamity of disaster)," in Daesoon Thought, divine beings (corresponding to the Heavenly and Earthly Realms) and human beings possess two attributes—property and substance—that are difficult to reconcile.⁸⁸⁶ It manifests in the aspect of 'Sin-in-uido' (Mutual Guidance between Divine Beings and Human Beings). The divine beings of Heaven and Earth (Cheonji-sinmyeong), upon which Heaven and Earth are based, are also divine beings; therefore, like digital systems, they are devoted to truth but have only one direction, whereas human beings, though not precise, possess bodies that can flexibly adapt to change.⁸⁸⁷ Like Cheonwon-jibang (Heaven is Round, Earth is Square), properties move in both directions like a circle, while substance moves in one direction like a square; therefore, combining these two attributes results in Sin-in-johwa (Harmonious Union between Divine Beings and Human Beings), resolving the problem. Kim Ji-ha expressed the principle of integrating the two opposing elements of substance and property as the "Aesthetics of White Shadow," which Kim Ik-du interpreted as liminality.⁸⁸⁸ The indigenous modernity of Daesoon Thought emphasizes the liminality and revitalization of correlative thinking.

In Donghak Thought, the Daoist development of the Heaven-human relationship was not revitalized, but in Daesoon Thought, it is specifically revitalized. Daesoon Thought is the only religious organization that venerates Jeungsan (Kang Il-sun) which honors the highest divine status (Singyeokwi) as Guchwon-eungwon-noeseong-bohwa-cheonjon-gangseong-sangje (Goo-cheon-eung-won-noe-seong-bo-hwa-cheon-jon-kang-seong-sang-je).

Comparison of the Heaven-Earth Relationships in Donghak and Daesoon Thought

⁸⁸⁵ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Jeosaeng" (Saving Lives) 43.

⁸⁸⁶ Yi Eo-ryeong, *Dijireukeu: Hangugin-i Ikkeoneun Cheomdan Jeongngsahoe, Geu Mirae-reul Inneun Kiwodeu* (Digilog: The Keywords for Reading the Future of the Advanced Information Society Led by Koreans), Seoul: Saenggak-ui Namu, 2006.

⁸⁸⁷ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Yeosi" (Prophetic Elucidations) 46.

⁸⁸⁸ Kim Ji-ha, (Mihak Gang-ui) Huin Geuneul-ui Mihak-eul Chajaseo ((Aesthetics Lecture) In Search of the Aesthetics of White Shadow), Seoul: Silcheon Munhaksa, 2005.; Kim Ik-du, "Reconciliation and Sangsaeng (Mutual Beneficence) in East Asian Thought: The Ideological Movements of Modern and Contemporary Jeonbuk and Their Development," Proceedings of the 93rd Academic Conference of the Society of Ancient East Asian Studies, 2023.

Cheonji Gwisin (天地鬼神) and Cheonji Seongyeongsin (天地誠敬信)

'Heaven-Earth ghosts-and-spirits (cheonji-gwisin)' and 'Heaven-Earth sincerity-respectfulness-faithfulness (cheonji-seonggyeongsin)' are terms that first appear, respectively, in Donghak Thought and Daesoon Thought, and that represent the Heaven-Earth relationship of the two thoughts. They are also two concepts that clearly show the difference between Donghak Thought, which emphasizes the emergence of the heaven-beyond-heaven, and Daesoon Thought, which emphasizes the human incarnation and descent of Gucheon. First, in the case of 'Heaven-Earth ghosts-and-spirits' in Donghak Thought—meaning that Heaven and Earth are beings made by the yin-yang principle of the transcendent Heaven—'ghosts-and-spirits' signifies the heaven-beyond-heaven of Donghak Thought and does not signify divine beings (sinmyeong). On the other hand, the 'Heaven-Earth sincerity-respectfulness-faithfulness' of Daesoon Thought—by which Heaven and Earth operate and foster all things and even humanity's blessings and lifespan are determined—emphasizes the sincerity-respectfulness-faithfulness of the divine beings.

Since both Donghak Thought and Daesoon Thought emphasize the heaven above heaven—that is, the transcendent Heaven—here 'Heaven and Earth (cheonji)' differs from the concept of Heaven and Earth as yin-yang in traditional Eastern thought. If Heaven is regarded as the transcendent Heaven, the Earth that stands opposite to it corresponds to both Heaven and Earth. Both 'Heaven-Earth ghosts-and-spirits (天地鬼神)' and 'Heaven-Earth sincerity-respectfulness-faithfulness (天地誠敬信)' signify the transcendent God and the attitude of the divine beings of Heaven and Earth toward the transcendent God.

Examined in detail, first, in Daesoon Thought the Three Realms coexist with the divine beings and operate by the sincerity-respectfulness-faithfulness of the divine beings.

天地誠敬信⁸⁸⁹

Life, longevity, and fortune are the grace of Heaven and Earth; therefore, establish the great righteousness of Cheonji-boeun (Grateful Reciprocation to Heaven and Earth) with Seong (Sincerity), Gyeong (Reverence), and Shin (Faith), and fulfill the human way (Indo).⁸⁹⁰

The two passages above mean that a human being's life, lifespan, and blessings are favors bestowed by the sincerity-respectfulness-faithfulness (seonggyeongsin) of the many divine beings who operate Heaven and Earth; therefore, a human being too, by emulating Heaven and Earth and reciprocating with sincerity-respectfulness-faithfulness, can qualify as a person worthy of receiving Heaven and Earth's favors. This is the background by which the Three Essential Attitudes among the creeds of Daesoon Jinrihoe become sincerity-respectfulness-faithfulness.⁸⁹¹

⁸⁸⁹ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gyoun" (Progress of the Order) 1-66.

⁸⁹⁰ Daesoon Jinrihoe Yeolam (Daesoon Jinrihoe Overview), "Hunhoe" (Admonitions).

⁸⁹¹ Daesoon Jinrihoe Yeolam (Daesoon Jinrihoe Overview), "Sinjo" (Creed/Beliefs).

Compared with Donghak Thought, which emphasizes the significance of the first emergence of the transcendent God, Daesoon Thought, which emphasizes the human incarnation and descent of Gucheon, emphasizes a different aspect of Heaven and Earth. First, Donghak Thought's 'Heaven-Earth ghosts-and-spirits' has the meaning of emphasizing the qi-transformation function (gihwa-jagyong) of the utmost qi (jigi) of the transcendent Heaven. Even before Donghak Thought arose, Neo-Confucianism too had expressed Heaven and Earth as ghosts-and-spirits, but the Heaven and Earth as ghosts-and-spirits in Neo-Confucianism was a substantialist explanation of yin-yang's operation. Donghak Thought, however, goes beyond Neo-Confucianism and emphasizes the transcendent Heaven. By emphasizing that Heaven and Earth being ghosts-and-spirits is not the operation of yin-yang but the qi-transformation function of the transcendent Heaven, it prepared a new modern turning point for Neo-Confucianism.⁸⁹²

Heaven and Earth too are ghosts-and-spirits (天地亦是鬼神), and ghosts-and-spirits too are yin-yang (鬼神亦是陰陽)—

Not having known it thus, what use is it to examine the classics?

Not having known the Dao and virtue, how could the worthies and noble gentlemen (賢人君子) know?⁸⁹³

In the passage above, 'ghosts-and-spirits' and 'Dao and virtue' carry the meaning of the transcendent Heaven, while 'the classics' and 'the worthies and noble gentlemen (賢人君子)' refer to the Dao of the heaven-below-heaven that Donghak seeks to overcome. Donghak Thought pursued, through the transcendent Heaven, a modernity that surpasses Neo-Confucianism; but because it could not accept even the concept of divine beings, it failed to go beyond the Confucian canon.

Donghak Thought, which accepted the concept of ghosts-and-spirits only in the sense of the transcendent Heaven and could not accept the concept of divine beings who heed the command of the transcendent Heaven, fails—owing to the absence of the concept of divine beings—to reach a successful modernity. Accordingly, Daesoon Thought, accepting the concept of divine beings, expresses Heaven and Earth as sincerity-respectfulness-faithfulness, over against Donghak Thought, which expressed Heaven and Earth as ghosts-and-spirits.

Sincerity-respectfulness-faithfulness (seonggyeongsin) is a term that centrally expresses the relationship between the transcendent Heaven and the human being in Eastern thought, which is a correlative thinking composed of yin-yang and the Five Elements. Donghak Thought too expresses Donghak Thought itself as a 'thought of sincerity-respectfulness-faithfulness.'

吾道博而約不用多言義

別無他道理誠敬信三字⁸⁹⁴

⁸⁹² Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gyoun" (Progress of the Order) 1-6.

⁸⁹³ Yongdam Yusa (Songs of Yongdam), "Dodeokga" (Song of Morality/Dao and Virtue).

Sincerity-respectfulness-faithfulness expanded gradually from the thought of sincerity (誠) in the Doctrine of the Mean to respectfulness (敬) and faithfulness (信), appearing in Donghak Thought as a term naming sincerity-respectfulness-faithfulness together. Naming sincerity-respectfulness-faithfulness together in Donghak Thought is because, like essence-energy-spirit (jeong-gi-sin), it seeks to express simultaneously the respective Heaven-Earth-Humanity elements contained in sincerity-respectfulness-faithfulness. In fact, sincerity (誠) is sometimes translated by today's Western researchers as 'creativity'.⁸⁹⁵

However, although the same term 'sincerity-respectfulness-faithfulness' is used, the concept of 'sincerity-respectfulness-faithfulness' is the part where Donghak Thought and Daesoon Thought—and further, even Confucian thought—differ most greatly. That sincerity (誠) was emphasized from Confucian thought onward is because sincerity was the part where Heaven and the human being connect. Just as utmost sincerity brings one into accord with Heaven, sincerity (誠) was the principal channel between Heaven and the human being, the principal method of human thorough penetration (hwaryeon-gwantong); hence sincerity (誠) was most valued in Confucian thought. Even early Western-Learning thinkers such as Yi Byeok, who encountered Western Learning through Confucianism, regarded sincerity (誠) as the link connecting Confucianism and the Western teaching. Donghak Thought emphasizes sincerity (誠) in the aspect of revitalizing the vanished Confucian tradition, but what differs from Confucianism is that it is sincerity toward not the Heaven of 'Heaven and Earth,' but the transcendent Heaven that made Heaven and Earth. Daesoon Thought, by contrast, goes further, so that this sincerity (誠) applies also to the Heaven and Earth created by Gucheon; the difference is that the concept of sincerity (誠) in Daesoon Thought appears within a triangular structure of Gucheon, divine beings, and human beings. In Daesoon Thought, a human being's reciprocation through sincerity (誠) applies to both Gucheon and Heaven-and-Earth.

Again, the concept of ghosts-and-spirits is also the part where Daesoon Thought and Donghak Thought—and further, Confucian learning—differ most greatly. As the expression 'Heaven-Earth sincerity-respectfulness-faithfulness' shows, in Daesoon Thought the concept of ghosts-and-spirits, or divine beings, has sincerity-respectfulness-faithfulness connected to the concept of divine beings, whereas in Donghak Thought or Confucian thought sincerity-respectfulness-faithfulness is not so connected. In Daesoon Thought, the role of the divine beings of Heaven and Earth, which was not specified in Confucian thought or Donghak Thought, is emphasized. Examined in more detail, this is as follows.

⁸⁹⁴ Donggyeong Daejeon (Eastern Canon), "Jwajam" (Seated Maxims). Odo-bak-i-yak, bul-yong-da-eon-ui, byeol-mu-ta-dori, seong-gyeong-sin-sam-ja. Our Dao is broad yet concise; there is no need for many words — there is no other principle, just the three characters Seong (Sincerity), Gyeong (Reverence), and Sin (Faith).

⁸⁹⁵ A. N. Whitehead, D. R. Griffin and D. W. Sherburne, *Process and Reality*, New York: Free Press, 1929, pp.10-11. Cited in: Roger Ames and David Hall, translated by Jang Won-seok, *Ilseongsa-e Chojeomssi Matchwigi: Jungyong-ui Beonyeok-gwa Cheolhakjeok Haesok* (Focusing on the Affairs of Daily Life: Translation and Philosophical Interpretation of the Zhongyong), Seongnam: Academy of Korean Studies Press, 2019, pp.50-51.

The concept of ghosts-and-spirits explained, from the standpoint of natural philosophy, as dispersing qi could not guarantee the eternity of the ghosts-and-spirits that are the objects of ancestral sacrifice; and the religious concept of ghosts-and-spirits, which reinforced eternity in order to support the significance of sacrifice, was not a theory that conformed without strain to the Neo-Confucian doctrine premised on the finitude of qi.

The ghosts-and-spirits interpreted from the natural-philosophical standpoint of Neo-Confucianism are, as the union of li and qi, beings that move back and forth between substance and phenomenon, being and non-being. Applying such a concept of ghosts-and-spirits to human affairs, it points to a being in the process leading from primordial non-being to birth, and from death back again to primordial non-being. In Li-Qi theory, ghosts-and-spirits are not an incomprehensible supernatural substance but the very intermediate process by which the various things and phenomena in nature come into being and perish—a concept grasping nature, composed of li (理) and qi (氣), from the aspect of its changing operation. As [the scholar] said, 'What manifests outwardly is qi (氣), and what is subtly immanent is li (理); taking these together, we call them ghosts-and-spirits.'⁸⁹⁶

Ghosts-and-spirits, although not at the dimension of fundamental beings like li or qi, were understood as that which, with li and qi bound together, really exists within nature and exercises a presiding power (jujaeryeok) that gives rise to change of itself. If ghosts-and-spirits are understood as qi (氣) alone, they will be perceived as thoroughly material; conversely, if regarded as li (理) alone, they will remain principle-like, abstract beings. Therefore, for ghosts-and-spirits to be a numinous being possessing presiding power of itself, they must have both elements, li and qi. However, in explaining ghosts-and-spirits, the questions of which of the two to weight more heavily, and of whether li and qi being together is coexistence (並存) or union (合一), became continuing topics of discussion among later Neo-Confucians.

In Neo-Confucianism, the human body too, like other things, is thought to be composed of qi (氣). The birth of a human being is accomplished when, within the mother's womb, the qi of the father and mother and the qi drifting around at that moment combine to form a single independent living being. Human death is that process running in reverse. When the life of a human being who had existed as an independent individual comes to an end, the qi that composed the body disperses into nature and disappears. Yet at this time, the dispersal of qi does not occur immediately at the moment of death but proceeds gradually over a long time. The logic that the various ancestral sacrifices, which the royal house and the scholar-official families of the Joseon period performed unceasingly with all their devotion, are directed not at a fiction or a notion but at a really existing being, is explained precisely on this ground. The ghost of the dead person who is the object of sacrifice—namely, the human-ghost (人鬼)—though a finite thing in the

⁸⁹⁶ Nam Hyo-on (author), Bak Dae-hyeon (translator), Chugangjip (Collected Works of Chugyang), Seoul: Minjok Munhwa Chujinhoe, 2007, vol. 5, 35b.

process of extinction, can, until it reaches complete extinction, partake of the sacrifice as a really existing being.

In light of the premise of Neo-Confucianism's Li-Qi dualism, which distinguishes the roles of li and qi, granting the capacity for action (作爲) to qi alone and allowing li only a principle-like character, some Neo-Confucians say that the doctrine of the immortality of the soul is an untenable theory. However, the point we must grasp meaningfully is that the substance called li (理), as conceived by the Neo-Confucians of the Joseon period, was not confined to a natural and ethical principle 'without feeling or intention (無情意)' and 'without contrivance (無造作),' but was sometimes also perceived as a numinous and luminous (靈明) being that guarantees the eternity of human existence.⁸⁹⁷

The conspicuous difference in the Heaven-Earth and Earth-human relationships of Donghak Thought and Daesoon Thought lies in the difference of their perception of the West. If Donghak, which first advocated autogenous modernity, emphasizes—as seen in the very name 'Donghak'—a stance of opposition to Western Learning (Seohak), Daesoon Thought emphasizes—as seen in the term 'Daesoon'—the point of embracing. Accordingly, with respect to autogenous modernity, Daesoon Thought presents the Eastern origin of Western modernity. To survey, in brief, the studies up to recently on the formation of Donghak Thought as related to autogenous modernity: Donghak Thought begins from the Eastern origin of Western modernity, is then re-imported into the East together with Western Learning, and again, modern Chinese Daoism such as the autogenously developed Nandan Daoism is synthesized with the existing Neo-Confucianism, taking form as a revelation of Sangje in the shape of the 'Dialogue with the Heavenly Teacher (Cheonsa-mundap 天師問答).'⁸⁹⁸

Dogi Jangjon (道氣長存) and Sangsaeng (相生)

The concept of 'mutual beneficence (sangsaeng)' is the term in which the most representative difference appears between the conceptions of Earth in Daesoon Thought and Donghak Thought. That the concept of mutual beneficence is used in connection with an abstract concept, as in 'resolution of grievances for mutual beneficence (haewon-sangsaeng),' first appears in Daesoon Thought among the Jeungsan-related thoughts. That sangsaeng, used in yin-yang and the Five Elements, can be used together with an abstract concept in Daesoon Thought has, as its background, the relationship of Gucheon and the divine beings—namely, To's mediation of Wood-Fire-Metal-Water, as seen in harmonizing (jori) and qi-transformation (gihwa).

Although the concept of yin-yang and the Five Elements appears in Donghak Thought as well and functioned as the standard of science in the East for some 2,000 years after Dong Zhongshu, the core

⁸⁹⁷ Hanguk Sasangsa Yeonguhoe (Research Group on the History of Korean Thought), Joseon Yuhak-ui Gaenyeomdeul (Concepts of Joseon Confucianism), Yemun Seowon, 2002.

⁸⁹⁸ Kim Yun-gyeong, Hanguk Dogyosa (History of Korean Daoism), Seoul: Munsacheol, 2020.

concept of yin-yang and the Five Elements being used together with 'resolution of grievances for mutual beneficence' is a theoretical derivation of yin-yang and the Five Elements viewed from the standpoint of Gucheon, like the Three Realms and the Three Powers, or the Former World and the Later World. In Daesoon Thought, yin-yang and the Five Elements—as appears in the 'Prospectus of Mugeuk-do' in the form of the virtuous concordance of yin and yang, the establishment of the Three Powers, and the completeness of the Five Elements—are, together with yin-yang and the Three Powers, the principle by which Gucheon operates the Three Realms.

In Daesoon Thought, according to the arrangement methods of yin-yang and the Five Elements known as the Hetu (Hado) and Luoshu (Nakseo), Gucheon operates yin-yang and the Five Elements, and accordingly the non-doing and self-transformation (muwi-ihwa) of birth-growth-harvest-storage (saengjang-yeomjang) occurs. The divine beings are infinitely superposed according to the intention of Gucheon and fulfill the role of the divine beings of Heaven and Earth—such is the worldview, by the autogenous modernity of Daesoon Thought, presented by Gucheon.

Here, mutual contention (sanggeuk) and mutual beneficence (sangsaeng) are elevated beyond the operating principle of yin-yang and the Five Elements to the core principle of all the myriad things. The traditional mutual contention and mutual beneficence are applied, by autogenous modernity, to everyday things, becoming the criterion for evaluating and judging everyday things.⁸⁹⁹

Yin-yang and the Five Elements appear in Donghak Thought too, but mutual contention and mutual beneficence are not emphasized. Mutual contention and mutual beneficence have their importance emphasized in the course of Gucheon's harmonizing of yin-yang and the Five Elements through the Reordering Works of Heaven and Earth after the human incarnation and descent. Yin-yang and the Five Elements appear not only as the Limitless (Mugeuk) emphasized in Donghak Thought, but also as the importance of the Supreme Ultimate (Taegeuk).⁹⁰⁰

The Supreme Ultimate unfolds from yin-yang into the Three Powers and the Five Elements, ultimately becoming yin-yang and the Five Elements; and what does not change within yin-yang and the Five Elements is the central 'To' (土, Earth) at the center. The yin-yang and the Five Elements that Dong Zhongshu combined were fully combined only through the Hetu and Luoshu, which Shao Yong rediscovered. Shao Yong, disclosing the Hetu, Luoshu, and the diagram of the Eight Trigrams of Fu Xi, which Confucius is legendarily said to have transmitted to the Daoist thinkers, unified yin-yang and the Five Elements with the Eight Trigrams. According to Shao Yong's interpretation of yin-yang and the Five Elements unified by the Hetu and Luoshu, the cosmos is the infinite repetition of yin-yang and the Five Elements, and yin-yang and the Five Elements are the movement in which Wood-Fire-Metal-Water move in mutual contention and mutual beneficence around the central 'To' (土). If yin-yang and the Five

⁸⁹⁹ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Jeosaeng" (Saving Lives) 43.

⁹⁰⁰ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Jeosaeng" (Saving Lives) 43.

Elements signify endless change, then, like the Supreme Ultimate, there is an unchanging being that makes yin-yang and the Five Elements change endlessly, and this is precisely li (理); corresponding to the qi (氣) of yin-yang and the Five Elements, it comes to possess the attribute of origination-flourishing-benefiting-firmness (wonhyeong-ijeong). In the end, in Shao Yong's system, li (理) is the invisible central 'To' (土) among the Five Elements and is origination-flourishing-benefiting-firmness, while qi (氣) is the Wood-Fire-Metal-Water that manifests around the periphery among the Five Elements and is yin-yang and the Five Elements.⁹⁰¹

In yin-yang and the Five Elements, mutual contention is, together with mutual beneficence, absolutely necessary. However, since balance between mutual contention and mutual beneficence is important, leaning toward mutual contention also risks maximizing mutual contention. The autogenous modernity of Donghak Thought pursues the power of mutual contention, as in its emphasis on the long preservation of the Dao's energy (do-gi-jangjon 道氣長存), qi-transformation (gihwa 氣化), and the repulsion of Japan (cheok-wae).

In Donghak Thought, the word 'do-gi-jangjon (道氣長存)' is a phrase appearing in 'Ipchunsi (Verse on the Beginning of Spring),' which Suun wrote at the beginning of spring of the Gyeongsin Year, just before the Dialogue with the Heavenly Teacher, resolving to devote himself to cultivation.

道氣長存邪不入, 世間衆人不同歸⁹⁰⁴

The text above can be thought of simply as a firm resolve regarding cultivation, but The Canonical Scripture (Jeongyeong) reveals that an important meaning is hidden in it from the standpoint of mutual contention and mutual beneficence.

In The Songs of Suwon, there is a saying, "If the energy of the Dao is maintained for a long time, wickedness cannot enter [道氣長存邪不入]." However, I say, "If a perfected heart is adamantly guarded, blessings will come first [眞心堅守福先來]."⁹⁰⁵

In the passage above, Suun's 'do-gi-jangjon (道氣長存)' is contrasted with 'jinsim-gyeonsu (眞心堅守, adamantly guarding a perfected heart).' In the passage above, 'do-gi-jangjon' contrasted with 'jinsim-

⁹⁰¹ Gao Huimin (author), Kwak Shin-hwan (translator), Sogangjeol-ui Seoncheon Yeokhak (Shao Kangjie's Xiantian Yixue [Prior Heaven Changes Studies]), Seoul: Simsan, 2007.

⁹⁰² In practice, the concept of Wonhyong-i-jeong (the four elemental attributes: origination, flourishing, advantage, firmness) is used to refer to the four common attributes of cyclical periods, such as spring-summer-autumn-winter, morning-midday-evening-night, and early-middle-mature-old age. It is said that, like an infinitely nested cycle, Wonhyong-i-jeong exists in every single affair and object, and in all affairs and all things. (Yun Yong-nam, "A Reconstruction of Zhu Xi's Theory of I" (Juja i-seol(理說)-ui Jaegusaeng), Dongyang Cheolhak Yeongu 8, 1988, pp.52-54)

⁹⁰³ Choe Jin-deok, "The I-Gi Theory and Gwisin Theory of Zhu Xi Studies (朱子學의 理氣論과 鬼神論)," Yangmyeonghak (Journal of Wang Yangming Studies), vol. 23, Korean Society of Wang Yangming Studies, 2009, pp.381-383.

⁹⁰⁴ Dogi-jangjon-sa-bul-ip, segan-jungin-bu-dong-gwi. When the Qi of the Dao is preserved for a long time, evil things cannot enter; I will not follow the same path as the multitude of the world.

⁹⁰⁵ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gyobeob" (Teachings) 2-3.

gyeonsu' emphasizes the meaning of countering force with force. Regarding countering force with force, The Canonical Scripture states the following.

Repaying evil with evil is the same as washing away blood with blood.⁹⁰⁶

To say 'do not repay evil with evil' does not mean that The Canonical Scripture tells one to grant an opponent's unjust demands. Rather, The Canonical Scripture criticizes as weakness the inability to refuse an unjust demand. It only emphasizes that, in solving a problem, mutual contention must be resolved through mutual beneficence.

In the autogenous modernity of Donghak Thought and Daesoon Thought, the part where mutual contention and mutual beneficence appear most conspicuously is the part related to the West and Japan. First, looking at the case of the West:

東有大聖人曰東學 西有大聖人曰西學⁹⁰⁷

In the passage above, Daesoon Thought regards Western Learning as being of the same rank of sages as Donghak. Unlike Donghak Thought, which displayed great wariness toward the West, Daesoon Thought regards East and West as a mutually beneficial relationship of the virtuous concordance of yin and yang. Matteo Ricci, for instance, also appears as a figure who broke through the boundary of East and West and transmitted the civilization of Heaven to Earth. In fact, even in the Practical Learning (Silhak) of the late Joseon period, there was an ambivalent attitude toward Western Learning.

The Christian thought that exerted influence among the scholars of the Seongho school, a representative school of late-Joseon Practical Learning, appears to have provoked broadly three types of response. The first, as in the case of An Jeong-bok, was to acknowledge that there was something to learn from Western Learning as science while clearly rejecting Christian thought as religion or philosophy. The second, conversely, was to accept Christian thought as religion and even to advance to the stage of believing in it; among Seongho's disciples, this corresponds to the so-called Faith-in-the-West faction (Sinseopa)—Yi Byeok (1754-1786), Gwon Cheol-sin (1736-1801), Yi Seung-hun (1756-1801), Yi Gahwan (1742-1801), and others. The third was the effort to take the stimulus of Christian thought as an occasion for returning to the original standpoint of ancient Confucianism, and thereby to establish a new theoretical system regarding the problems of nature and the human being. The philosophy of Jeong Yak-yong (1762-1836), counted among the representative figures of late-Joseon Practical Learning, corresponds to this third case. Jeong Yak-yong, a representative scholar of the time, is said to have acknowledged

⁹⁰⁶ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gyobeob" (Teachings) 1-34.

⁹⁰⁷ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Haengrok" (Acts) 5-38. Dong-yu-daeseong-in-wal-donghak, seo-yu-daeseong-in-wal-seohak. In the East there is a great sage, and it is called Donghak (Eastern Learning); in the West there is a great sage, and it is called Seohak (Western Learning). (Gyomubu, "Dolbyeongpung" (Stone Screen), Daesoon Hoebo (Daesoon Circular) 119, 2011)

Sangje and Li-Qi theory while denying the yin-yang and the Five Elements that form the theoretical basis of the divine beings of Heaven and Earth.⁹⁰⁸⁹⁰⁹

Next, looking at the case of Japan: the first Reordering Work of Heaven and Earth to be realized after Jeungsan's passing into Heaven was the 'Resolution of Japan's Grievances (Ilbon-haewon).' Compared with Donghak Thought's 'dog-like Japanese enemies,' Daesoon Thought says that, since the Japanese too are people, one should at least treat them generously in speech.⁹¹⁰⁹¹¹

One day, Sangje said, "If I took Joseon (Korea) over to the West, it could not survive, being abused due to racial discrimination. And if I took Joseon over to Qing, its people, who are dull and stupid, could not afford to take the responsibility. There have been grievances between the gods of both nations who have presided over arts of the Dao since the Imjin War (1592-1598), so I will hand Joseon over to Japan in order to resolve the grievances there. I shall temporarily give them the power of unifying the world and the greatly bright energy of the sun and moon to do the work. But I shall never grant them one thing: benevolence. If they were endowed with benevolence, the entire world would be under their control. I will confer the word of benevolence to you. Keep it well. You shall live in relative safety while only they work. Accordingly, do everything accurately for them to handle. When they finish the work, they will return to their country empty-handed without wages. At the very least, use refined language with them."

The Canonical Scripture (Jeongyeong), rather than mutual contention with Japan, presents as an interpretation of history by autogenous modernity the mutually beneficial path by which, after the resolution of Japan's grievances—connected even to the fall of Baekje and thereafter to the Imjin War—Joseon can receive China's reciprocation and become a nation of superior rank.

Comparison of the Heaven-Human and Earth-Human Relationships in Donghak and Daesoon Thought

The Heaven-Human Relationship of Human Way (人道) and Divine Way (神道)

Daesoon Thought, with the terms 'Heavenly mandate (cheonmyeong 天命)' and 'divine teaching (singyo 神教),' distinguishes the human Way (indo 人道) carried out by humans and the Way of gods (sindo 神道) carried out by divine beings.

⁹⁰⁸ Hanguk Sasangsa Yeonguhoe (Research Group on the History of Korean Thought), Joseon Yuhak-ui Gaenyeomdeul (Concepts of Joseon Confucianism), Yemun Seowon, 2002.

⁹⁰⁹ Kim Seon-hee, "The Theistic World as Seen by a Confucian Scholar," Proceedings of the Korean Academy of Religion Conference, Korean Academy of Religion, 2014; Jeon Seong-geon, "The Theological Possibilities of Dasan's Theory of Spiritual Knowledge (Yeongji)," Proceedings of the Korean Academy of Religion Conference, Korean Academy of Religion, 2014)

⁹¹⁰ Go Nam-sik, "The Patterns and Significance of Japan-Related Records in the Transmission of Kang Jeungsan in the Modern and Contemporary Period: Focusing on the Daesoon Jeongyeong (大巡典經) (1929-1965)," Ilbon Geundae Hak Yeongu (Journal of Japanese Modern Studies), 2023.

⁹¹¹ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gongsa" (Reordering Works) 2-4.

When Sangje resided in Gucheon (the Ninth Heaven), the Sinseong (Divine Sages), Buddhas, and Bodhisattvas appealed that without Sangje, the chaotic Heaven and Earth could not be rectified; therefore, He descended to the Cheongyetap (Heavenly Revelation Pagoda) in the Great French Nation of the West, looked over the Three Realms, made a great tour (Daesoon) of the world, and then stopped in the Eastern Land, residing in the Golden Maitreya Statue at Geumsan Temple on Moak Mountain for thirty years, during which He bestowed the Heavenly Mandate (Cheonmyeong) and Divine Teaching (Singyo) upon Choe Su-un to establish the Great Dao; however, in the Gapja year (1864), He withdrew the Heavenly Mandate and Divine Teaching, and in the Sinmi year (1871), He decided to descend into the world Himself.⁹¹²

The core difference between the Way of gods and the human Way is that, since divine beings are constituent elements of Heaven and Earth, the Way of gods entails structural change. Accordingly, the Way of gods, which proceeds in parallel with the Reordering Works of Heaven and Earth, appears in the form of a re-establishment of the Heaven-human relationship.⁹¹³

“If all things, no matter how large or small, are ruled by the Dao of gods, profound and inscrutable accomplishments shall be gained. This is the way of changing without need for action. With the Dao of gods, all things can be performed in accordance with the righteousness of the Dao. By doing so, I will determine the destiny of the boundless paradisiacal land of immortals. A new foundation shall be opened when the Degree Number reaches the right time.”

“If someone had to undertake the mission of defending against the Japanese army in the Imjin War (1592-1598), Choi Pung-Heon would have brought it to a close within three days. Jin-Muk would have taken no longer than three months. Song Gubong could have done it within eight months. This is only due to the fact that Daoism, Buddhism, and Confucianism have different arts of the Dao. In the past, the ground was small and affairs were simple, so it was possible to clear confusion away with just one method. However, today, as the improved contact between the East and the West has broadened the ground and complicated the affairs, it is not possible to redress chaos unless all methods are integrated and used.”⁹¹⁴

In the passage above, the expression 'a new foundation shall be opened as the destiny (unsu) reaches the right time' indicates that, since divine beings are constituent elements of Heaven and Earth, the Way of gods entails structural change. In the end, Daesoon Thought laments that Donghak Thought, failing to understand sufficiently the Way of gods of 'Heavenly mandate' and 'divine teaching,' scarcely mentioned divine beings and could not greatly depart from the human Way. Traditionally, the human Way carries the meaning of an artificial Way, while the Way of gods carries the meaning of the necessary Way of nature,

⁹¹² Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Yeosi" (Prophetic Elucidations) 1.

⁹¹³ Sindo (the Way of Divine Beings) is also seen as the ultimate reality and the basis for Haewon Sangsaeng (Resolution of Grievances for Mutual Beneficence). (Kim Eui-seong, Daesoon Sasang-ui Cheolhakjeok Tamgu (A Philosophical Inquiry into Daesoon Thought), Sungkyunkwan University Doctoral Dissertation, 2017)

⁹¹⁴ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Yeosi" (Prophetic Elucidations) 73.

like natural law. Daesoon Thought too follows the traditional distinction between the human Way and the Way of gods.⁹¹⁵

In Donghak Thought, the emergence of the heaven-beyond-heaven was epoch-making, but because it could not explain the existence and role of divine beings, the relationship between the heaven-beyond-heaven and the human being could not escape the scope of the Confucian human Way. Donghak Thought chose the path of the human Way (人道), communicating with the heaven-beyond-heaven by doing the best a human being can do.

One day, Sangje's disciples wrote down their names while thinking about the all-time greatest generals in accordance with His orders. Gyeong-Seok asked Sangje, "Is the founder of a dynasty one of the greatest generals as well?" Sangje said, "Yes, he is." Gyeong-Seok enumerated the generals from the Yellow Emperor, King Tang, King Wu of Zhou, Jiang Taigong and Emperor Gaozu of Han, to others, ending with Jeon Myeong-Suk (Jeon Bong-Jun). Then he gave the paper to Sangje. Sangje asked him, "Why did you put Jeon Myeong-Suk at the end?" Gyeong-Seok replied, "Jeon Myeong-Suk is the first if read from the left." Sangje agreed with him and said to His disciples, "Jeon Myeong-Suk is one of the greatest generals of all ages. He was a poor scholar without a government position, yet he moved the world."⁹¹⁶

In the passage above, the Donghak Peasant Movement sought to favor the lowborn and make them yangban, and it became the fuse for a series of events extending from the Sino-Japanese War to the Russo-Japanese War and the First and Second World Wars. Donghak Thought is evaluated, not only at the time but also today, as the truly original modern ideological movement, predating even the French Revolution, so that a World Revolutionary Cities Solidarity Conference is held annually in Jeongeup. In Daesoon Thought, however, in the Heaven-human relationship, the Way of gods (神道) that communicates together with the divine beings of Heaven and Earth is emphasized more than the human Way (人道) of Donghak Thought, which seeks to communicate directly with the heaven-beyond-heaven.

水生於火 火生於水 金生於木 木生於金 其用可知然後 方可謂神人也

陰殺陽生 陽殺陰生 生殺之道 在於陰陽 人可用陰陽然後 方可謂人生也

人爲陽 神爲陰 陰陽相合然後 有變化之道也

不測變化之術 都在於神明 感通神明然後 事其事則謂之大仁大義也⁹¹⁷

⁹¹⁵ Daesoon Jichim (Daesoon Guidelines), Chapter 1, Section 1.

⁹¹⁶ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gongsa" (Reordering Works) 1-34.

⁹¹⁷ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Jeosaeng" (Saving Lives) 43. Su-saeng-eo-hwa hwa-saeng-eo-su geum-saeng-eo-mok mok-saeng-eo-geum gi-yong-ga-yong-yeonhu bang-ga-wi-sinin-ya. Eum-sal-yang-saeng yang-sal-cum-saeng saeng-sal-ji-do jae-co-eumyang in-ga-yong-eumyang-yeonhu bang-ga-wi-insaeng-ya. In-wi-yang sin-wi-eum eumyang-sanghap-yeonhu yu-byeonhwa-ji-do-ya. Bul-cheuk-byeonhwa-ji-sul do-jae-eo-sinmyeong gam-tong-sinmyeong-yeonhu sa-gi-sa-cheuk-wi-ji-daein-daceui-ya. Water (Su/水) is generated from Fire (Hwa/火(火)) and Fire (Hwa/火(火)) from Water (水); Metal (Geum/金(金)) from Wood (Mok/木); Wood (木(木)) from Metal (Geum/금(金)) — only after one can know their

In the passage above, the human is yang and the divine beings are yin (人爲陽 神爲陰); and since one can be called a human only when one knows how to use yin and yang (人可用陰陽然後 方可謂人生也), a human being acquires the minimum condition of being a human who knows how to use yin and yang only by knowing how to work together with the divine beings (感通神明然後 事其事).⁹¹⁸

Sangje said, "In the Seoncheon (Former World), all human affairs and things were governed by Sangguk (mutual conflict/overcoming), causing grievances to accumulate and form knots, filling the Three Realms; thus, Heaven and Earth lost their constant way (Sangdo), giving rise to all sorts of disasters, and the world became tragic." "Therefore, I intend to rectify the Dosu of Heaven and Earth, harmonize the divine beings (Sinmyeong), resolve the grievances of all time, and establish the Seon'gyeong (Immortal Realm) of the Hucheon (Later World) through the Dao of Sangsaeng (mutual beneficence), thereby saving the people of the world." "In all matters, great or small, the grievances must be resolved starting from the Sindo (Dao of Gods/Divine Beings)." "First, if the Dosu is firmly established and harmonized, that will become the foundation, and human affairs (Insa) will be accomplished spontaneously." "This is precisely the Samgye-gongsa (Work of the Three Realms)," He said to Kim Hyeong-ryeol, and He began a part of it, the Myeongbu-gongsa (Work of the Realm of Judgment).⁹¹⁹

In the passage above, the content 'one must, without distinction of great or small affairs, resolve grievances starting from the Way of gods' reveals that Donghak Thought and Western modernity, failing to understand the parts of divine beings and grievances, could not show successful results in matters great and small.

In Daesoon Thought, the characteristic of Confucianism is regarded as a human-centered doctrinal system that does not emphasize divine beings—called 'maintaining decorum (yuji-beomjeol).' Indeed, Confucianism has traditionally held to the tradition of 'revering yet keeping at a distance (敬而遠之)'—acknowledging divine beings (敬) but not drawing close to them (遠之).⁹²⁰

function (用) can one be called a Spirit-Human (신인(神人)/Sinin). When Yin is killed Yang lives, and when Yang is killed Yin lives; the path of life-and-death (생살(生殺)/生殺) resides in Yin and Yang. Only after a person can employ Yin and Yang can one be called a living human being. A human becomes Yang and the divine being becomes Yin; only after Yin and Yang harmonize together is there a path of transformation. Moreover, the arts of unfathomable transformation (방술(方術)/方術) all reside in the divine beings (신명(神明)/神明); only after communing with (감통(感通)/感通) the divine beings and an affair is accomplished, this is called Great Humaneness and Great Righteousness (대인대의(大仁大義)/大仁大義). (Yang Mu-mok, "Yin-Yang Hapdeok as Salvific Truth and Democracy," Daesoon Sasang Nonchong (Journal of Daesoon Thought) 2, 1997, pp.175-176)

⁹¹⁸ It is said that the concept of Yin-Yang emphasized and pursued in Daesoon Thought advocates Jeong-eum-jeong-yang (正陰正陽, Correct Yin and Correct Yang) and Hapdeok (合德, Virtuous Concordance) through harmony, and shows that an ideal world can be built through them. (Yi Ho-yeol, Daesoon Sasang-ui Eumyangnon-e gwanhan Yeongu (A Study on the Theory of Yin-Yang in Daesoon Thought), Daejin University Master's Thesis, 2015)

⁹¹⁹ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gongsa" (Reordering Works) 1-3.

⁹²⁰ Fan Chi asked about wisdom. The Master said: "Devote yourself to the duties owed to people; and respect spiritual beings (Gwisin), while keeping them at a distance — this can be called wisdom." (Analects (Noneo), "Yongya" chapter)

That the re-establishment of the view of the Three Realms connects with the Heaven-human relationship is through the re-establishment of the divine-human relationship known as harmonizing (jori) and qi-transformation (gihwa). After the human incarnation and descent of Gucheon, harmonizing and qi-transformation can now turn mutual contention into mutual beneficence, making possible, through the human being, the creative transformation (johwa) of the divine beings and the resolution of grievances (haewon) of humans.

The difference between Donghak Thought, which emphasizes the emergence of the heaven-beyond-heaven, and Daesoon Thought, which emphasizes the human incarnation and descent of Gucheon, is that humanity's mediation of contradiction through empathy—that is, the human use of yin and yang—is achieved through humanity's harmonizing (jori) and the divine beings' qi-transformation (gihwa). Shao Yong, like The Canonical Scripture (Jeongyeong), shows that the human being can harmonize the divine beings through the empathy and righteousness of the mind.

The Earth-Human Relationship of Simgeub Doyu (心急道儒) and Dotong Gunja (道通君子)

The most prominent difference in the view of the Earthly Realm (Jigyegwan) between Donghak Thought and Daesoon Thought is that Daesoon Thought's Gaebyeok (Great Opening) specifies the Dotong (Unification with the Dao) of the twelve thousand Dotong-gunja (Virtuous Scholars Who Have Attained the Dao) through Geumgangsan (Diamond Mountain) and the subsequent Dotong-jingyeong (Perfected State of Unification with the Dao). In Donghak Thought, which does not involve Sinmyeong (divine beings), the realization of the Dao manifested as social practice. In the society of that time, the realization of the Dao was the worldly desire that even commoners could become kings, nobles, generals, and ministers (Wanghu-jangsang). For those practicing Donghak Thought, the meaning of the emergence of the Cheon-oe-cheon (Heaven beyond Heaven) culminated in Simgeupdoyu (Daoist-Confucians with an impatient mind).⁹²¹

Simgeupdoyu refers to the subject of Su-un's admonition to Donghak followers, which appears in "Tan Doyusimgeup" (Lamenting the Impatient Mind of Daoist-Confucians) in the Donggyeong Daejeon, presumed to be a late work.⁹²² Su-un referred to Donghak followers as Doyu (Daoist-Confucians), and through this poem, he warned the Donghak followers who wished for the results of their spiritual cultivation to appear quickly, calling them Simgeupdoyu.⁹²³

⁹²¹ Yu Ji-yeon, "Hwang Hyeon (1855-1910)'s Perception and Criticism of Donghak: Focused on the Oha Gimun (梧下記文)," Irwon Haksul (梨院 學錄) Nonchong (Academic Theses Collection) 2, 2004, pp.1-54.

⁹²² Kim Gi-seung, "A Chronological Review of the Works of Su-un Choe Je-u," Donghak Hakbo (Journal of Donghak Studies) 3, 2002, pp.159-162.

⁹²³ The great fortune of mountains and rivers all returns to this Way, for its source is deepest and its principle extends farthest. Only by firmly establishing the mind-pillar (心柱) within oneself can one know the taste of the Way; only by keeping one's thought here will all affairs proceed as one wishes. Sweep away the turbid energy and nurture the clear energy as tenderly as

山河大運 盡歸此道 其源極深 其理甚遠 — The great destiny of the mountains and rivers all returns to this Dao; its source is exceedingly deep, its principle exceedingly far-reaching.

固我心柱 乃知道味 一念在茲 萬事如意 — Firmly holding the pillar of my mind, I come to know the savor of the Dao; when a single thought rests here, all affairs go as one wishes.

消除濁氣 兒養淑氣 — Dispel and remove the turbid energy, and nurture the pure energy as one rears a child.

非徒心至 惟在正心 隱隱聰明 仙出自然 — It is not merely that the mind arrives; it lies only in rectifying the mind. Quietly and subtly comes clear intelligence, and the immortal emerges of its own accord.

來頭百事 同歸一理 — The hundred affairs to come all return to a single principle.

他人細過 勿論我心 我心小慧 以施於人 — Do not let another's small faults trouble my mind; the small wisdom of my mind, bestow it upon others.

如斯大道 勿誠小事 臨勦盡料 自然有助 — For so great a Dao as this, do not lavish sincerity on trifling matters; when facing a task, give it your full reckoning, and help will come of itself.

風雲大手 隨其器局 玄機不露 勿爲心急 — The great hand of wind and cloud accords with one's capacity and measure; the profound mechanism is not disclosed, so let not the mind be hasty.

功成他日 好作仙緣 心兮本虛 應物無迹 — When merit is accomplished on a later day, make good the affinity for immortality; the mind is by nature empty, responding to things without leaving a trace.

心修來而知德 德惟明而是道 — When the mind is cultivated, one comes to know virtue; when virtue is bright, this is the Dao.

在德不在於人 在信不在於工 — It lies in virtue, not in other people; it lies in faith, not in labor.

在近不在於遠 在誠不在於求 — It lies in the near, not in the far; it lies in sincerity, not in seeking.

不然而其然 似遠而非遠 — Not so, and yet it is so; seemingly far, and yet not far.

On the other hand, Daesoon Thought, which introduced Sinmyeong (divine beings) through the incarnation of Gucheon (Sangje), aimed to realize the Jiseon-sinseon (Earthly Immortals) and Jiseon-cheonguk (Earthly Paradise) in this world, but unlike Donghak Thought, it did not desire to become kings,

rearing an infant. It is not merely a matter of the mind reaching its utmost—it lies solely in rectifying the mind. Subtle luminosity naturally arises with a spirit-like grace, and all affairs yet to come will return to a single principle. Do not debate the small faults of others within your own mind; bestow your small wisdom upon others. Do not devote the great Way to petty affairs. When confronted with great matters and one exhausts all deliberation, assistance will naturally come. The great fortune of wind and clouds follows one's capacity and scope. The profound and wondrous mechanism does not manifest itself—do not let the mind grow impatient. On another day when merit is accomplished, one will properly form a bond with the immortals. The mind is originally empty, and even when responding to things, it leaves no trace. Only by cultivating the mind can one know virtue, and it is the Way that solely illumines virtue. It lies in virtue and not in other people; it lies in faith and not in study; it lies in what is near and not in what is far; it lies in sincerity and not in seeking—it seems not so yet it is so; it seems far yet it is not far. Cheondogyo Gyeongjeon (The Cheondogyo Scriptures)

nobles, generals, and ministers (Wanghu-jangsang) through undue haste (Yoksok-budal).⁹²⁴ Daesoon Thought remained faithful to daily life with a long-term perspective looking far into the Hucheon (Later World). Daesoon Thought, which considers the Hucheon (Later World), states that Cham Donghak (True Eastern Learning) is that which specifies the emergence of Geumgangsán (Diamond Mountain) and the Dotong-gunja (Virtuous Scholars Who Have Attained the Dao) after the Gaebyeok (Great Opening)—which do not appear in Donghak Thought—and aims to produce these Dotong-gunja.⁹²⁵ Since the Daesoon view of the Three Realms aims for the production of Dotong-gunja as a priority, the Earth-human relationship (Ji-in-gwangye) also develops centered around the Dotong-gunja. In the Earth-human relationship of Donghak Thought, the Dotong-gunja and Geumgangsán are not specified, but they appear in the phrase "great men are the spiritual energy of the earth" (Ingeol-eun-jiryeong) and in references to Sinseon (Immortals).

Although Donghak Thought, which became a practical example of "making the whole country Yangban," maximized the intensity of practicing egalitarianism to the point of "making the whole country kings, nobles, generals, and ministers," the Jeon-gyeong interprets this as Su-un failing to overcome the limitations (Jeonheon) of Confucianism.⁹²⁶

One day, Sangje said to Kim Hyeong-ryeol, "The Westerner Matteo Ricci (Yi Madu) came to the East and tried to establish an earthly paradise, but he could not achieve his goal because the deep-rooted evil customs of Confucianism made reform difficult. However, he opened the boundaries between the Celestial and Subterranean Realms, allowing the divine beings (Sinmyeong), who had firmly guarded their respective regions and could not cross over, to interact, and after his death, he took the civilization divine beings (Munmyeongsin) of the East to the West and opened the way for cultural development (Mun-un). From this, the Subterranean divine beings (Jihasin) emulated all the wondrous methods of the Celestial Realm and bestowed them upon the human world. All the cultures and materials of the West are modeled after the Kingdom of Heaven," He said, "That civilization, being biased toward materialism, has instead fostered human arrogance and, in its attempt to conquer nature and shake the Heavenly Principle, has continuously committed all sorts of sins, undermining the authority of the Sindo (Dao of Divine Beings). Consequently, the proper ways (Sangdo) of the Heavenly Dao and Human Affairs (Insa) were violated, the Three Realms fell into confusion, and the source of the Dao was severed. Therefore, all the primordial divine saints, Buddhas, and Bodhisattvas gathered and appealed to Gucheon (the Highest Heaven) regarding this calamity (Geobaek) of humanity and the Spirit Realm. Thus, I descended to the Celestial Revelation Pagoda (Cheongyetap) in the great Western nation of France, inspected (Daesun) the world, and then stopped in this Eastern land, arriving at the Maitreya Golden Buddha statute in the three-story hall of

⁹²⁴ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gongsá" (Reordering Works) 3-41.

⁹²⁵ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gwonji" (Authority and Foreknowledge) 1-11.

⁹²⁶ Kim Sang-jun, "Making the Whole Country Yangban: The Confucian Egalitarian Mechanism in Late Joseon," *Sahoe-wa Yeoksa* (Society and History, formerly *Hanguk Sahoesa Hakhoe Nonmunjip*) 63(0), 2003, pp.5-29

Geumsansa Temple on Moaksan Mountain. After staying for thirty years, I revealed the Daedo (Great Dao) for saving the world (Jesedaedo) to Choe Je-u. However, as Je-u was unable to overcome the limitations (Jeonheon) of Confucianism and reveal the true meaning of the Daedo, I finally withdrew the Heavenly Mandate (Cheonmyeong) and Divine Teaching (Singyo) in the Gapja (1864) year and descended in the Sinmi (1871) year."⁹²⁷

In the excerpt above, the 'true meaning of the Daedo' is presented as an alternative modernity to Western modernity, which was biased toward materialism and fostered human arrogance; Daesoon Thought presents the purpose of Donghak Thought as an ideology that transcended Confucianism. Just as ontogeny recapitulates phylogeny, the 'true meaning of the Daedo' had to be a new truth that transcended Confucianism and gathered only the strengths of all principles. Therefore, the Cham Donghak (True Eastern Learning) that Donghak failed to realize was to transcend the modernity of 'making the whole country kings, nobles, generals, and ministers' and to realize 'Earthly Immortals' (Jiseon-sinseon).

One day, Sangje took Gyeong-seok from Nongam and, on the way to Jeongeup, stopped at a tavern in Wonpyeong, called over a passerby, bought him alcohol, and said, "This road is the sea route to Namjoseon (Southern Joseon). We must load much cargo before departing," and then hurried on the road, reaching a place thirty ri away, saying, "A great formation (Daejin) travels thirty ri in one party," and stayed at the house of Park Gong-woo, who lived in the jaesil (ritual house) of the Choe family in Songwol-ri, Gobu. He said to Gong-woo and Gyeong-seok, "Now that I have met the one I was meant to meet, the Tongjeongsin (Spirit of Mutual Understanding) emerges. My work is something that even my parents and siblings do not know." He continued, "I descended to the Cheongyetap (Tower of Divine Revelation) in the Great Western Nation of France, toured the world (Daesoon), and then, taking the authority of the Three Realms (Samgye), I came to open a paradise (Seongyeong) through the Gaebyeok of the Three Realms and save the people of the world who have fallen into annihilation; the reason I stopped in this land while touring your Eastern country is to first help the obscure, weak nation buried in calamity and resolve the grievances accumulated throughout the ages. Those who follow me will receive eternal fortune and blessings, achieve immortality, and enjoy the pleasures of an eternal paradise; this is the True Donghak. In the Gungeul-ga (Song of Gungeul), it is said, 'The lands and rivers of Joseon are a famed land (Myeongsan). A Dotong Gunja (Gentleman who has attained the Dao) will be born again'; this also refers to my work. It is transmitted among Donghak followers that a Daeseonsaeng (Great Teacher) will be reborn (gaengsaeng); this means a Daeseonsaeng (Teacher of the Era) will emerge again, and I am that Daeseonsaeng."⁹²⁸

In the excerpt above, the original purpose of Donghak is shown to go beyond advocating the Confucian 'anti-feudal, anti-foreign' stance, and to develop into an indigenous modernity leading to the Hucheon (Later World), a new world—that is, Cham Donghak (True Eastern Learning).

⁹²⁷ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gyoun" (Progress of the Order) 1-9.

⁹²⁸ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gwonji" (Authority and Foreknowledge) 1-11.

The Hucheon (Later World), the new world, is the world of Jiseon-sinseon (Earthly Immortals) and Dotong-gunja (Virtuous Scholars Who Have Attained the Dao), and the Jiseon-sinseon is another form of Eumyang-hapdeok (Virtuous Concordance of Yin and Yang) between Earth and humanity, which are in a Yin-Yang relationship. The slogan of Jiseon-sinseon (Earthly Immortals) is manifesting as reality today. If we introduce the correlative thinking of Yin-Yang and the Five Elements, which has hitherto been overlooked in studies on the indigenous modernity of Donghak Thought and Daesoon Thought, the Jiseon-sinseon (Earthly Immortals) can be understood as the following Eumyang-hapdeok (Virtuous Concordance of Yin and Yang) relationship between Earth and humanity.

Since the concept of the Samjae (Three Powers: Heaven, Earth, and Humanity), human beings have been regarded as equal to Heaven and Earth, but there has been little explanation as to why human beings can be equal to Heaven and Earth. Daesoon Thought clearly refers to the human-centricity mediated by Heaven and Earth—that human beings are compatible with Heaven and Earth, and that human beings must exist for Heaven and Earth to succeed—as Sin-in-johwa (Harmonious Union between Divine Beings and Human Beings). In Daesoon Thought, although human beings are incomparably small in scale and function compared to Heaven and Earth, they organically become beings equal to Heaven and Earth in that they are compatible with Heaven and Earth by combining the two aspects of Heaven and Earth as Yin and Yang. Before Daesoon Thought, human beings' status was only formally equalized with Heaven and Earth through the Samjae (Three Powers) and Samgye (Three Realms). Before the emergence of Daesoon Thought, human beings were indeed like specks of dust compared to Heaven and Earth. The characteristic of the Earth-human relationship (Ji-in-gwangye) in Daesoon Thought is that through human Dotong (Unification with the Dao), human beings can become beings who mediate and are compatible with Heaven and Earth.

Daesoon Thought has expressed the process leading from Donghak through the Donghak Peasant Revolution to Jeungsan Thought as a process of harmony (Johwa) consisting of Jakran (Creating Disorder), Dongran (Causing Turmoil), and Chiran (Remedying Disorder). If the correlative thinking of the concept of "harmony" (Johwa), which began in Donghak Thought, is interpreted as "liminality," the modernity manifested in Donghak and Daesoon Thought (as Cham Donghak) can be compared, focusing on the concept of the view of the Three Realms (Samgye-gwan), where correlative thinking is concentrated.⁹²⁹ Daesoon Thought, which proclaimed Cham Donghak (True Eastern Learning), actually materializes Yin-Yang and the Five Elements as its ideological indigenous nature, starting from the initial Mugeukdo prospectus—which outlined Eumyang-hapdeok (Virtuous Concordance of Yin and Yang), Samjae-hwakrip

⁹²⁹ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gyobeob" (Teachings) 3-30; Go Nam-sik, "Kang Jeungsan's Historical Consciousness and View of Joseon in the Late Joseon Period," *Dongasia Godaehak (Journal of Ancient East Asian Studies)* 59, 2020, pp.239-270, p.259.

(Establishment of the Three Powers), and Ohaeng-gubi (Completion of the Five Elements)—more so than Donghak Thought.⁹³⁰

⁹³⁰ Murayama Jijun, "Mugeukdo Chwiji-seo" (Mugeukdo Prospectus), Joseon-ui Yusa Jonggyo (Quasi-Religions of Joseon), Daegu: Gyemyeong University Press, 1991.